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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

(PLATES 38–50)

THE sixth and seventh excavation campaigns in the Minoan town site at Roussolakkos were undertaken from 23 May to 8 July 1994 and from 1 to 26 July 1996.¹ The aims were to clarify the architectural remains partially revealed in 1990–1 in the area between Buildings 5 and 7 and ‘Main Street’, now called Building 6,² and to link up the recent excavations with those of the turn of the century. The final site plan is given in FIG. 1, and an aerial photo of the excavations at PLATE 38, with detail of the area of Building 6 at PLATE 39. We treat Building 6 as three sectors: an Eastern Zone, a North-West Quarter, and a South-West Quarter, because of differences in construction technique that may reflect variations in function. The prime remains are found in the South-East

¹ The excavations were carried out under the auspices of the British School at Athens; we are most grateful to the chairmen, R. A. Tomlinson and Gerald Cadogan, and to the Managing Committee for their continued support and encouragement. We are also very much indebted to the Directors, E. B. French and R. A. Tomlinson, and the School’s staff in Athens for their assistance throughout the years. Permission to excavate was given by the Greek Ministry of Culture, for which we are grateful to Dr Y. Tzedhakis. Dr N. Papadakis in Siteia very much facilitated the work and provided the supervision and collaboration of Ms E. Tzangarakis in 1994 and Ms D. Koinakis in 1996. The necessary financial support was provided by the Institute for Aegean Prehistory, whom we continue to value as our primary sponsor. The aerial photograph in PLATE 38 was taken by J. Driessen who acknowledges the support of the Belgian F.W.O.

The excavations were directed by L. H. Sackett and J. A. MacGillivray. The architects were J. M. Driessen and P. Jerome. S. Dandali was administrative assistant. Trench supervisors in 1994 were T. Cunningham, S. Hemingway, J. Mason, M. Naughton, I. Schoep, S. Thorne, assisted by A. Harris, D. and S. Jacovini, R. Krieger, K. Sendler, S. You, A. Wasse, and V. Isaakidou; in 1996 they were T. Cunningham, E. Hatzakis, A. Marcar, P. Tomkins and S. Wallace assisted by V. Kyriakidis, L. Preston, D. Romanou, E. Sackett, K. Sendler, and S. Vázquez. Video notebooks were kept by S. Moss in 1994 and A. Lesk in 1996. The apotheke was run by H. Parton and A. Sackett, assisted in 1994 by E. Bonn and Robin O’Nan. The computer archives constructed by B. Howenstein were implemented by C. Sarther and J. Romalo in 1994 and J. Rempel in 1996. Conservators were P. Harrison, A. Brysbaert, and M. Moak in 1994 and N. Karanikolas, M. Naunton and M. Tziotziou in 1996. Pottery processing was supervised by J. A. MacGillivray, assisted in 1994 by A. Marcar and in 1996 by S. Janssen. Bone was processed by C. Walker in 1994 and S. Crowther in 1996; soil samples were processed in 1994 by J. Jones assisted by J. Stewart and T. Aretaki and in 1996 by V. Isaakidou. Small finds and tools were studied by D. Evelyn. Drawings are by P. Murray assisted in 1994 by R. Moak, A. Currelly, and S.

Bell. C. Doherty is geological consultant. Twenty workmen and technicians were supervised by N. Daskalakis.

This report was written by J. A. MacGillivray and L. H. Sackett incorporating texts by J. M. Driessen. Special reports by J. M. Driessen, Ilse Schoep and Eleni Hatzaki are included as separate headings.

Special abbreviations:

PK I–VII = ‘Excavations at Palaikastro I’ to ‘VII’, in *BSA* 8 (1901–2), 286–316; 9 (1902–3), 274–387; 10 (1903–4), 192–321; 11 (1904–5), 258–308; 12 (1905–6), 1–8; 60 (1965), 248–315; and 65 (1970), 203–42 respectively.

PK 1986–8, 1990–1 = ‘Excavations at Palaikastro, 1986’ to ‘1988’ in *BSA* 82 (1987), 135–54; 83 (1988), 259–82; 84 (1989), 417–45; and ‘1990’ to ‘1991’ in *BSA* 86 (1991), 121–47; 87 (1992), 121–52 respectively.

PK Settlement = ‘Minoan settlement at Palaikastro’, in P. Darque and R. Treuil (eds), *L’Habitat Égéen préhistorique* (BCH supp. 19, Paris, 1990), 395–412.

PK Survey = ‘An archaeological survey of the Roussolakkos area at Palaikastro’, *BSA* 79 (1984), 129–59.

PKU = R. C. Bosanquet and R. M. Dawkins, *The Unpublished Objects from the Palaikastro Excavations 1902–1906*, Part I, (BSA supp. paper 1 London, 1923).

PKU II = ‘Unpublished objects from Palaikastro and Praios’, *BSA* 40 (1939–40), 38–59.

TAW iii = D. A. Hardy (ed.) *Thera and the Aegean World*, iii (London, 1990).

Zakros = N. Platon, *Zakros* (New York, 1971).

Metric height above sea level is indicated thus: 10.61⁺.

² The area includes ‘Block M’ of 1904, which was tested at its south and east perimeters by Bosanquet’s team, was considered too eroded to excavate and used for dumping spoil. We found that while severe erosion had affected LM I A remains, an unusual opportunity was afforded to research the underlying early Neopalatial and earlier deposits and structures, and the evidence suggests that the area never had any later buildings. Meanwhile during the twentieth century the spread of the first excavators’ dump (covering up to a metre of bark on the old olive trees) has provided good protection for the northern part of this area, as far as the line of the old calderimi at Buildings 5 and 3.

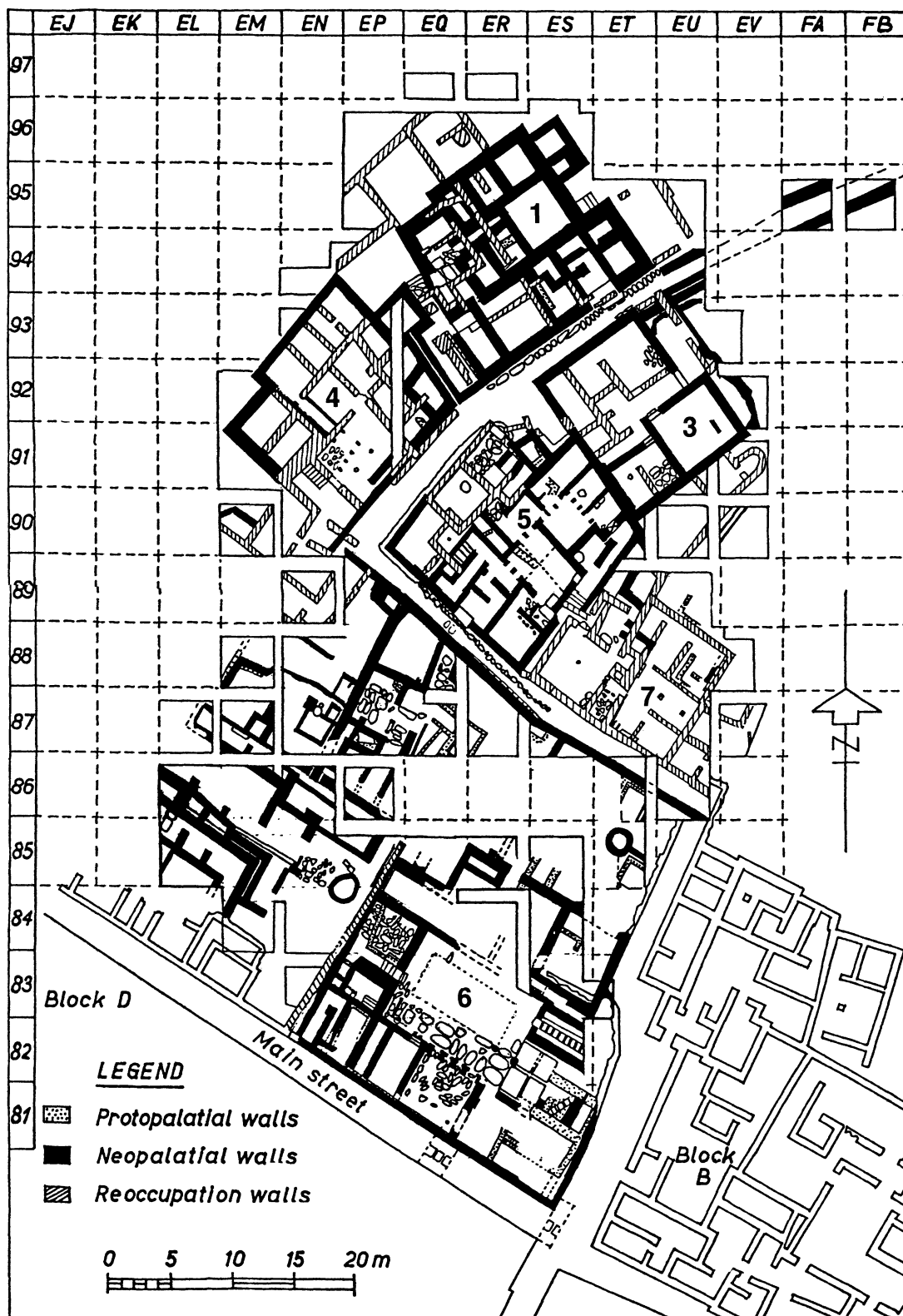


FIG. 1 Palaikastro site plan 1996.

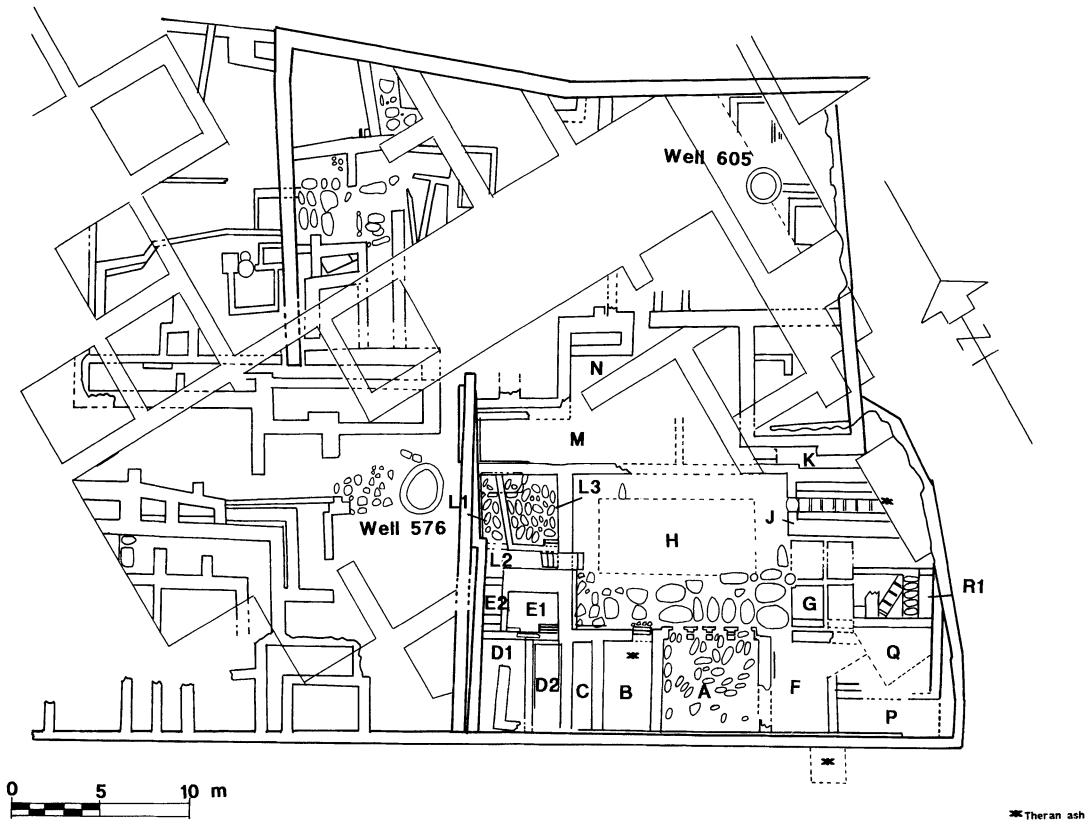


FIG. 2 Plan of Building 6, 1996.

Building complex comprising (as so far known) a small court surrounded by some fifteen rooms or spaces. Facing onto Main Street at the south and onto the street shared with Block B at the east, it is delimited by major terrace walls at north and west, the ancient ground level having been considerably higher at the west and lower at the north. Since most of the work done in 1994 and 1996 relates to this South-East Building complex, the term 'Building 6' is normally used in this report to refer to this sector, the other zones being denoted more specifically in the following outline of the work done there. A schematic plan of this sector of Building 6, with Room assignments, is at FIG. 2; general views of the site at the end of the 1996 season are at PLATES 46–47.

SUMMARY OF THE PROGRESS OF 1990–4 EXCAVATIONS WITHIN THE WIDER AREA OF BUILDING 6

Excavation within this area began in 1990, when seven trenches on the south side of the alleyway 5/6 revealed parts of open paved areas, and of a building, with associated MM III B and LM I A pottery deposits.³ The unburnt destruction contexts of the latter were thought to

³ PK 1990, 133–5; plan at figs. 1–2; pottery at figs. 11–13.

be earthquake-related. Traces of an earlier (MM II) building phase with red plaster floors were also found, and the surprising fact was noted that no evidence for post-LM I A structures existed here and that the area thus could be interpreted as a walled open area from LM I B onwards.⁴

In 1991 a further 27 trenches were opened in this area, concentrated in the North-West and South-West sectors, where eroded buildings and paved areas, again of MM III B and LM I A date, were revealed.⁵ Though difficult to interpret, these structures were consistently oriented on the same line as Main Street and so were regarded as a related unit (forming part of the Building 6 complex); further, the occurrence of a wine-press establishment suggested an industrial function for this western sector.⁶ Once again unburnt destruction contexts characterized the main period, while traces of a MM II predecessor and of an abandonment in the later periods seemed to confirm the 1990 interpretations. Two interesting additions were the discovery of high quality painted plaster,⁷ which suggested that a fine Neopalatial building had existed nearby, and of the upper courses of a circular structure in EP/EN 85 which located the position of Well 576.

In 1994 and again in 1996 most of the work was concentrated in the South-East Building complex; however, there were significant developments in the North-West and South-West Quarters, which are discussed briefly here before we treat this main sector of Building 6.

THE WEST ZONE OF AREA 6

Work was carried out in three areas: first to the south-east in EN 84/5, where the excavation of Well 576 unexpectedly absorbed most of our time and efforts (with commensurately valuable results); secondly to the south-west in EL/EM/EN 85/6, where baulk removal and select tests revealed more of the still puzzling architectural features; and thirdly to the north-west in EN/EP 87/8, where the clearance of a collapsed late terrace wall and baulk removal revealed more of the lower LM I A paved court there, and added to the metallurgical deposit found in 1991 and now published separately by Sean Hemingway.⁸

The MM III B and LM I A Periods

In the South-West Quarter, whose western edge remains undefined,⁹ an elongated open court at EL/EM 86 gives access, via a covered room at EM/EN 85, to the small paved court which was cut through by the later Well 576. To the south-west is a façade having a sequence of perhaps three wall foundations and apparently fitted with column bases (rather than buttresses). These could have supported a balcony with plaster and pebble floor¹⁰ which looked out over the sea to the north-east. The façade fronted a well-built but still largely unexcavated building, which shows more than one construction phase and was probably entered directly from Main Street at the south-west.

⁴ PK 1990, 133.

⁵ PK 1991, 125–9; plans at figs. 1 and 3, finds at figs. 2, 3, 6, 7.

⁶ For the wine-press and possible production of plaster here, see PK 1991, 126.

⁷ PK 1991, 128 and fig. 6.

⁸ 'Metalworking in the Postpalatial period: a deposit of metallurgical debris from Palaikastro', *BSA* 91 (1996), 213–52, pls. 39–40.

⁹ In an attempt to find out whether the unusual architectural features and chronology of Area 6 continued

further north and west, as opposed to the normal pattern of LM IB destruction, two trenches were opened opposite (i.e. NE of) Block N, at EG 87 and EH 88. The results were inconclusive: fragmentary walls but no floor or good deposits were encountered in EG 87; a small compartment probably of LM I date but partly rebuilt and with plaster floor largely cut away by an LM III A1 pit was the principal feature of EH 88.

¹⁰ Material of this kind had fallen into the centre of the three small compartments found at ground level beneath.



FIG. 3 Building 6, Minoan Hall (A) and surrounds, 1994 plan.

Immediately to the north-east, terraced down on lower ground, a series of parallel supporting walls form elongated spaces (?storage basements) that border the industrial establishments of this quarter.¹¹ The removal of the collapsed LM III terrace wall at EP 87/9 and of three baulks opened up more of the lower paved courtyard here, which is furnished with three series of Cape Sidero slabs and to the north-east of this an area of schist paving. Possible candidates for column bases both in this courtyard (regular sideropetra blocks) and on the damaged north wall (circular hollows) need further study. For now it seems probable that a paved way (now blocked and built over by the south wall of alley 5/6) originally led up from the predecessor to Building 5 to the north-east, entered this paved court, and took one to the wide staircase with stone treads linking this low-lying North-West Quarter with the higher area to the south. This staircase would have risen over the elongated basements referred to above and could have joined a corridor immediately east of Well 576, thus linking with the small paved court there.

¹¹ See n. 4.

LM I B–LM III

Area 6 appears to have been abandoned during the LM I A period and thereafter left open. A boundary wall may have been constructed all round the area. The north wall at the alley 6/5 was certainly in existence in LM I B. At the south the sideropetra foundation at Main Street seems to belong to a post-LM I A build. Some of the walling at the east street is also a late build; and to the north-west the major LM III terrace wall in EN/EP 88, based on earlier foundations at its north end, may perhaps follow an earlier, LM I B line. The only wall within this broad area which may be LM I B (and later) is the major cross-wall dividing the lower East Zone from the higher West Zone at EN 83 to EP 85 (discussed further below). Elsewhere the only post-LM I A stratigraphy consists of a surface with a kind of 'garden soil' and deposits of ogival cups at the extreme north, beside the Alley 6/5. Thus basically the whole area is devoid of LM I B and later architecture, the only built features of the period being two wells, Well 605 to the north-east in ET 85, and Well 576 towards the centre in EN 84.

Well 605 (PLATES 41 *a*, 48 *b–c*, 49; FIGS. 5 *a*, 6–13)

Well 605 is circular with diameter *c.*1.20 m and lined with fine flat and rectangular slabs, tightly set together. The well shaft was first cut down through earlier (MM and ?LM I A) buildings and through bedrock to a depth of 8.0 m. Among the debris of a MM III B destruction of this area was found a fine bridge-spouted jar with ripple-pattern (FIG. 4). Lower down at *c.*1.50 m from the bottom a stone ring was built, packed with rubble and clay mortar behind. The lower rock-cut part is slightly wider than the 6.50 m of stone-lined shaft (see sketch section at FIG. 5 *a*). The south side of the well-head was repaired and slightly widened at a later date, possibly even when it was serving as a dumping ground for refuse (LM III), for traces of a pebble-strewn earth layer of LM III date were found on its north-west side, higher than the LM I B 'garden' level found nearby to the northeast. The fill provided an extremely valuable ceramic sequence of both closed and open shapes, running from LM I B through LM II and LM III A₁ to a final rubbishy fill of LM III A₂/B character. For the LM I B period we illustrate a selection of conical and ogival cups (FIG. 6), and plain and decorated jugs (FIGS. 7–9). For the LM II period we illustrate a variety of cups (FIG. 10, nos. 1–5) and a large squat jar of unique form and fabric (FIG. 10, no. 6). The LM III A₁ period is represented by conical cups (FIG. 11, nos. 1–4), a bell-shaped cup (FIG. 11, no. 5), a shallow bowl (FIG. 11, no. 6), a pyxis (FIG. 11, no. 7) and a decorated jar (FIG. 11, no. 8; PLATE 48 *c*). FIG. 12 shows characteristic forms of the LM III A₁–2 period, including a shallow bowl (no. 1), kalathos (no. 2), bell cups (nos. 4 and 5), a pulled rim bowl (no. 6), conical cups (nos. 7–12), and a two-handled jar with open spout (no. 13), the latter two in the blot-and-trickle style; and also a finely painted pyxis with bird and floral pattern (FIG. 12, no. 3; PLATE 48 *b*). In addition from here comes the fragment of a fine serpentine rhyton with scenes of dolphins in a seascape of rocks and seaweed¹² (FIG. 13; PLATE 49).

Well 576 (PLATES 41 *b–c*, 42 *d*, 48 *a*; FIGS. 5 *b*, 14)

Well 576 is oval in shape and much larger at diameter *c.*2.00 × 1.50 m. The well shaft was cut down through conglomerate bedrock to a depth of 9.50 m, and it passed through an under-

¹² A similar representation of dolphins in a seascape is a scene on a gilt cushion seal, also from Palaikastro,

acquired by Arthur Evans in 1894 (*PM* iv, fig. 441).



FIG. 4 Bridge-spouted jar (94/5178) from south of Well 605, MM III B. Scale 1/3.

ground cavity roofed with small stalactites from which water seeped in.¹³ Only the upper 2.20 m were stone-lined and for this large blocks were used and carefully placed. The well-head shows some signs of repair at its south side. The only trace of an occupation level which could go with the well was a patch of pebbled floor on the north side, for the well shaft cut down (on its west side) through the earlier paved floor which is the latest architectural feature in this area. The remarkable size of the well shaft suggests that it could have functioned as a public water source.

The fill provided a very similar chronological sequence to that of Well 605 (FIG. 5 *b*). The primary deposit comprised a large number of LM I B water jars, and was sealed by a massive dump of building rubble including the fragments of at least three horns of consecration, comparable to those found in the late phase (LM I A) of Room B of the East Building. These are listed and discussed below. The occurrence of a clean silt layer, comparatively high up in the shaft and associated with LM III A₁ pottery (including water jars, as shown at PLATE 42 *d*)

¹³ This factor may explain the unusual size of the well, if the roof of the underground cavity collapsed and it was necessary to cut a wider area to support the sides safely. In any event the result was a shaft large enough for four or five

people to draw water at one time, for two or more excavators and one recorder to work together as far down as the bottom of the shaft, and (unusually) for a stratigraphical cross-section to be recorded on a stone by stone basis.

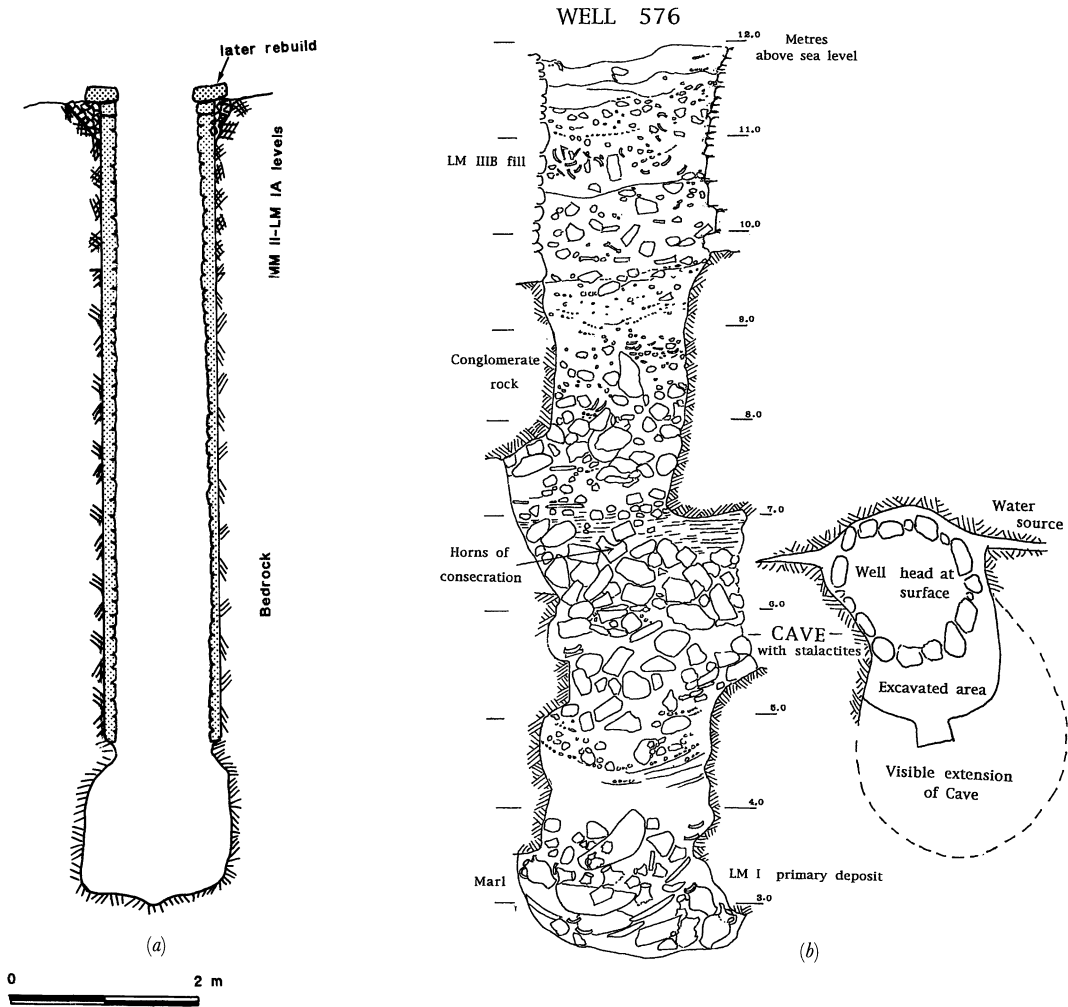


FIG. 5 (a) Schematic section of Well 605 (JMD); (b) stratigraphic section of Well 576 (S. Thorne).

suggests that there was at least a seasonal reuse of the well during this period. Later LM III rubbish packed the upper shaft and included polluting elements such as dog carcasses, showing vividly that it now served only as a convenient rubbish pit.

Together these two wells provide an unusually valuable source for a stratified sequence of LM I B–LM III B material.¹⁴ A selection of the finds is illustrated at PLATE 48 and FIGS. 6–14.

¹⁴ Thus it is planned to give priority to their publication, which is currently being prepared by Stuart

Thorne and Eleni Hatzaki.

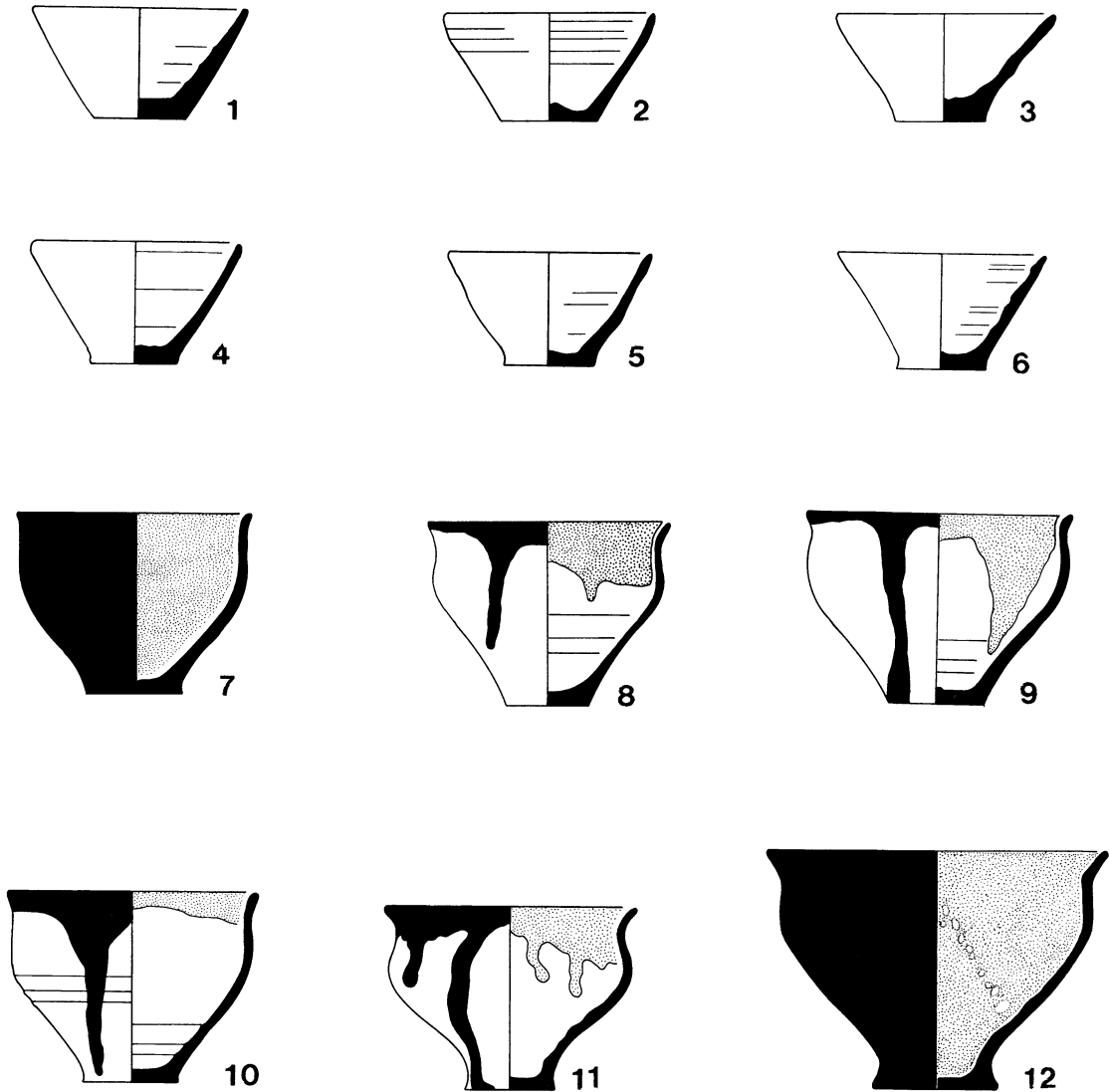


FIG. 6 LM I B conical and ogival cups from Well 605. Scale 1/3.

Building 5 Well

Further work in this well, begun in 1990,¹⁵ showed that the stone-lined shaft continued down to depth *c.* 6.20 m. A further 0.70 m was excavated into bedrock, but work was much delayed by the need to consolidate the upper shaft with cement, for it was only 0.70 m in diameter, and constructed of loosely set irregular rubble. Furthermore the fill has so far consisted mainly of large blocks deriving from the LM I B destruction(s) and these could only be moved after heavy work with a hammer.

¹⁵ PK 1990, 126.

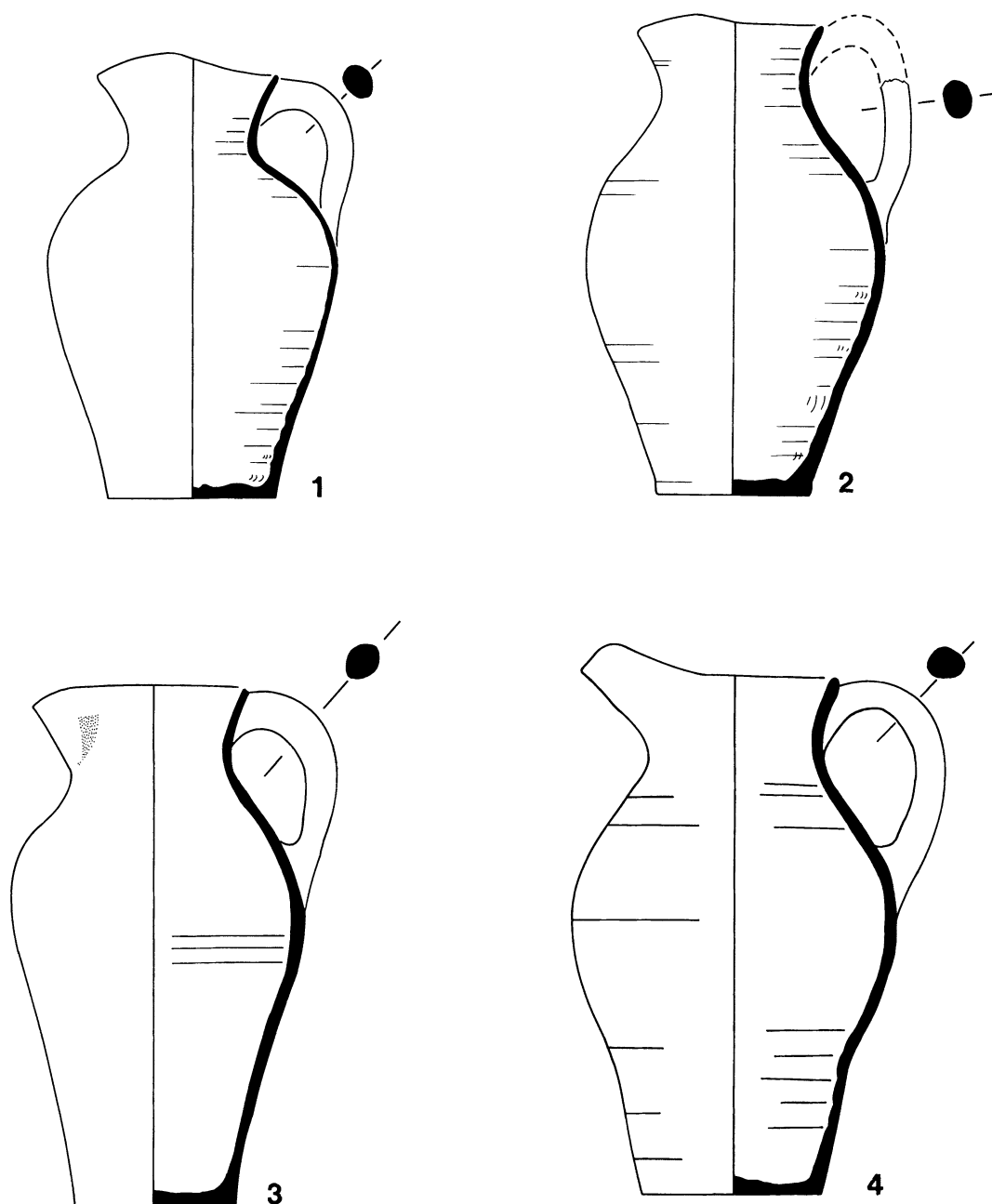


FIG. 7 LM I B plain jugs from Well 605. Scale 1/3.

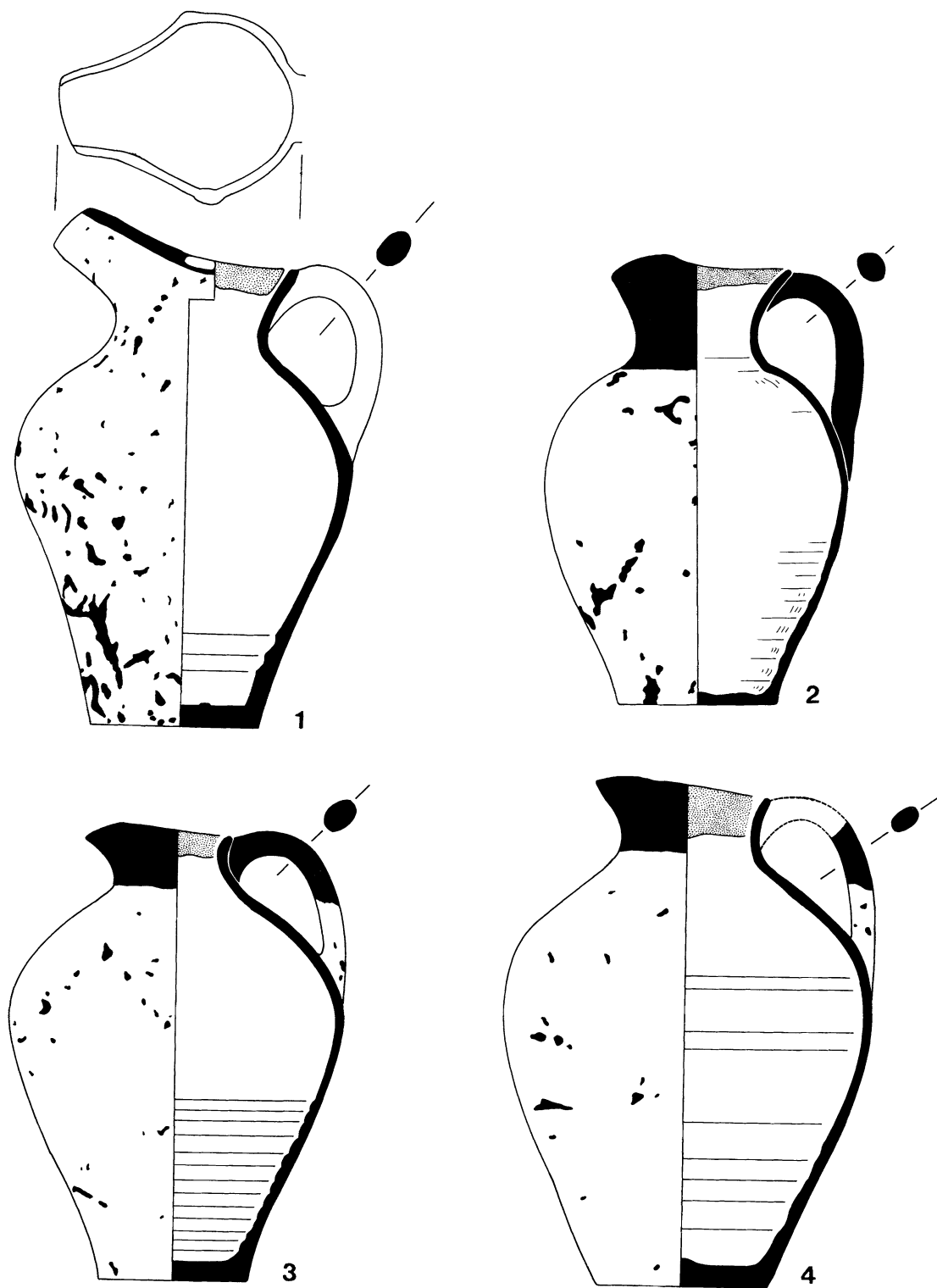


FIG. 8 LM I B spray-painted jugs from Well 605. Scale 1/3.

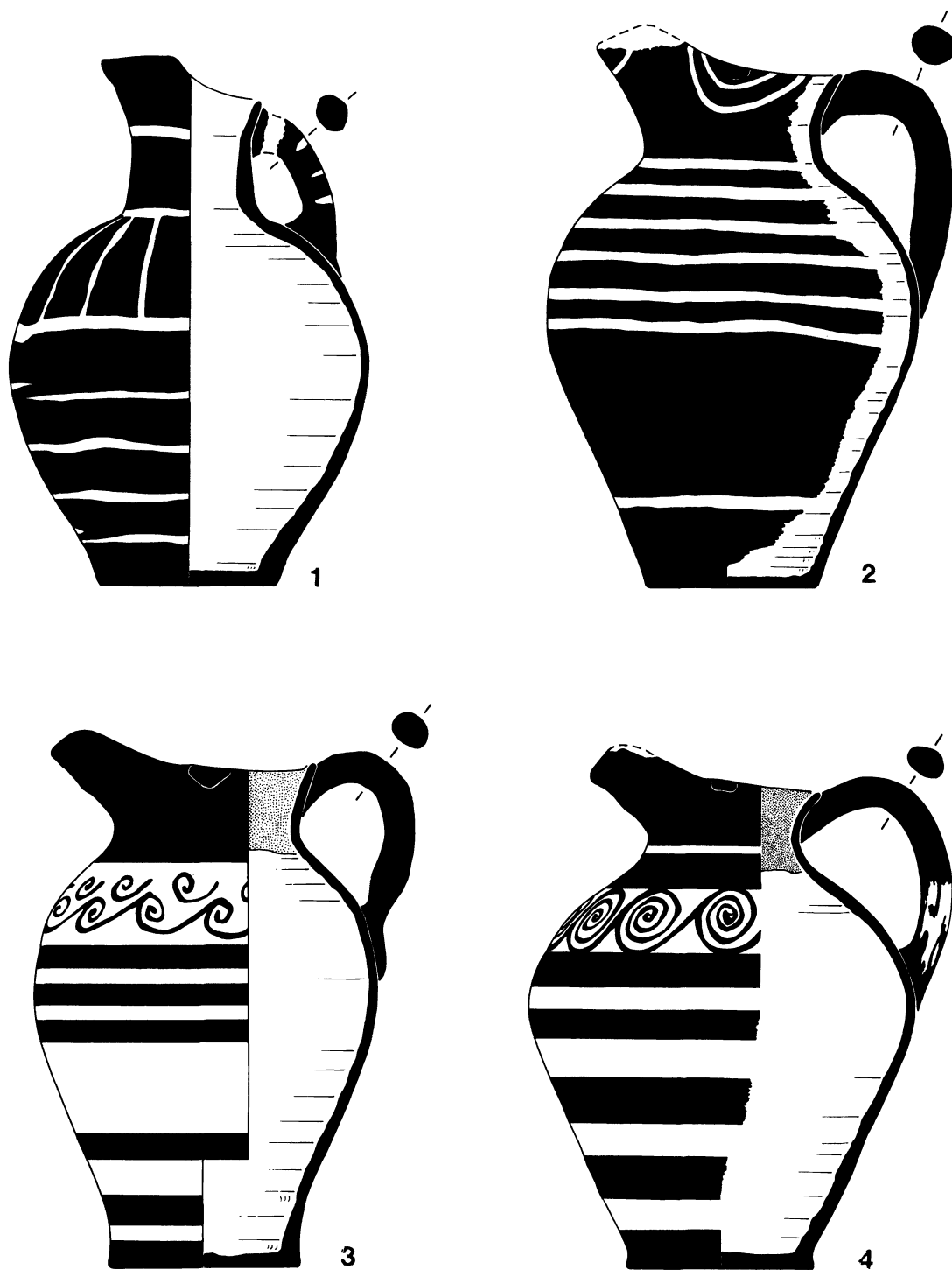


FIG. 9 LM I B decorated jugs from Well 605. Scale 1/3.

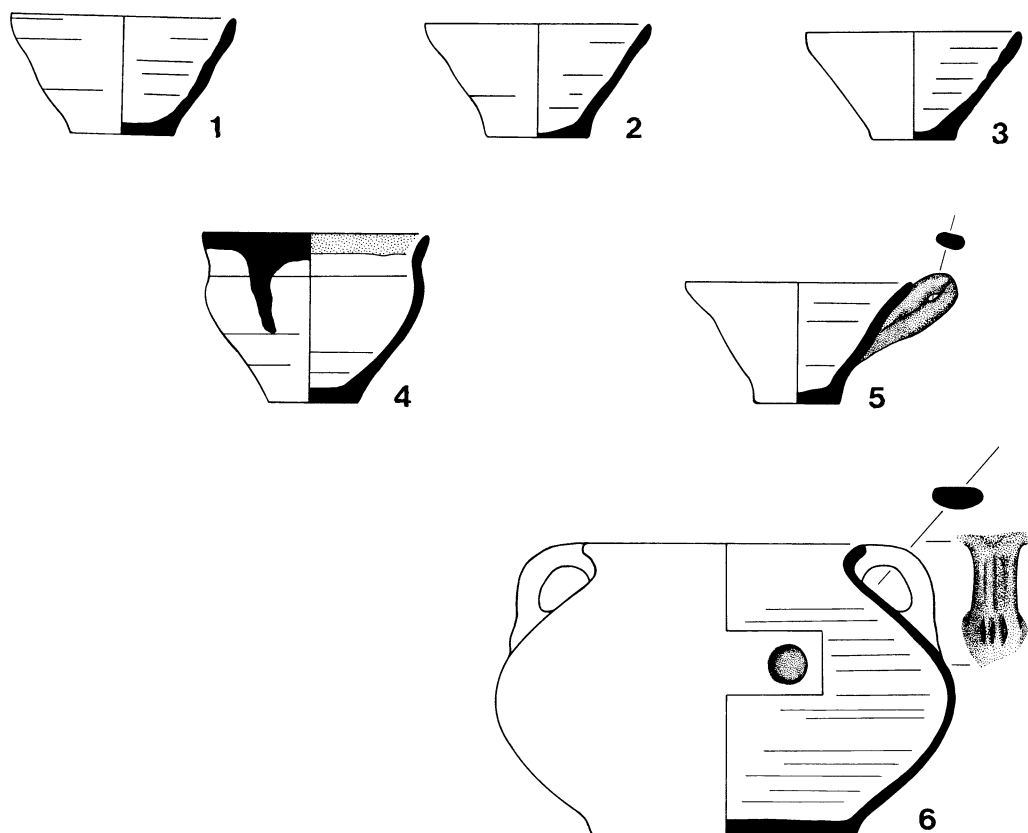


FIG. 10 LM II cups and large squat jar from Well 605. Scale: nos. 1–5 at 1/3; no. 6 at 1/6.

The Eastern Zone:

Building 6, the main architectural complex in the South-East Quarter

By the end of the 1994 season the main outlines of this architectural complex had been revealed.¹⁶ This was interpreted as a structure hitherto unparalleled at Palaikastro, perhaps with Knossian connections, having a monumental paved entrance (G on plan at FIG. 2), probably leading in from the northern branch of Main Street, opposite Block B.¹⁷ This entrance would have led to a central court with plastered surface, bordered by a paved colonnade or stoa mostly now lost but to be restored on all four sides (H). The central element of the building also included a second plastered area adjacent to this on the north side, but probably originally subdivided (M). A series of rooms opened on to this central area, the most important being a large paved hall entered by a pier and door system on the south side (A),

¹⁶ Plan at *AR* 41 (1994–5), 69.

¹⁷ Excavation was not completed here and interpretation has been frustrated by a combination of severe ancient robbing and erosion, followed by the disturbance of the

test trenches of Bosanquet's excavation with the inaccessibility of the street wall itself owing to close field boundaries with a complex legal history. See further discussion below.

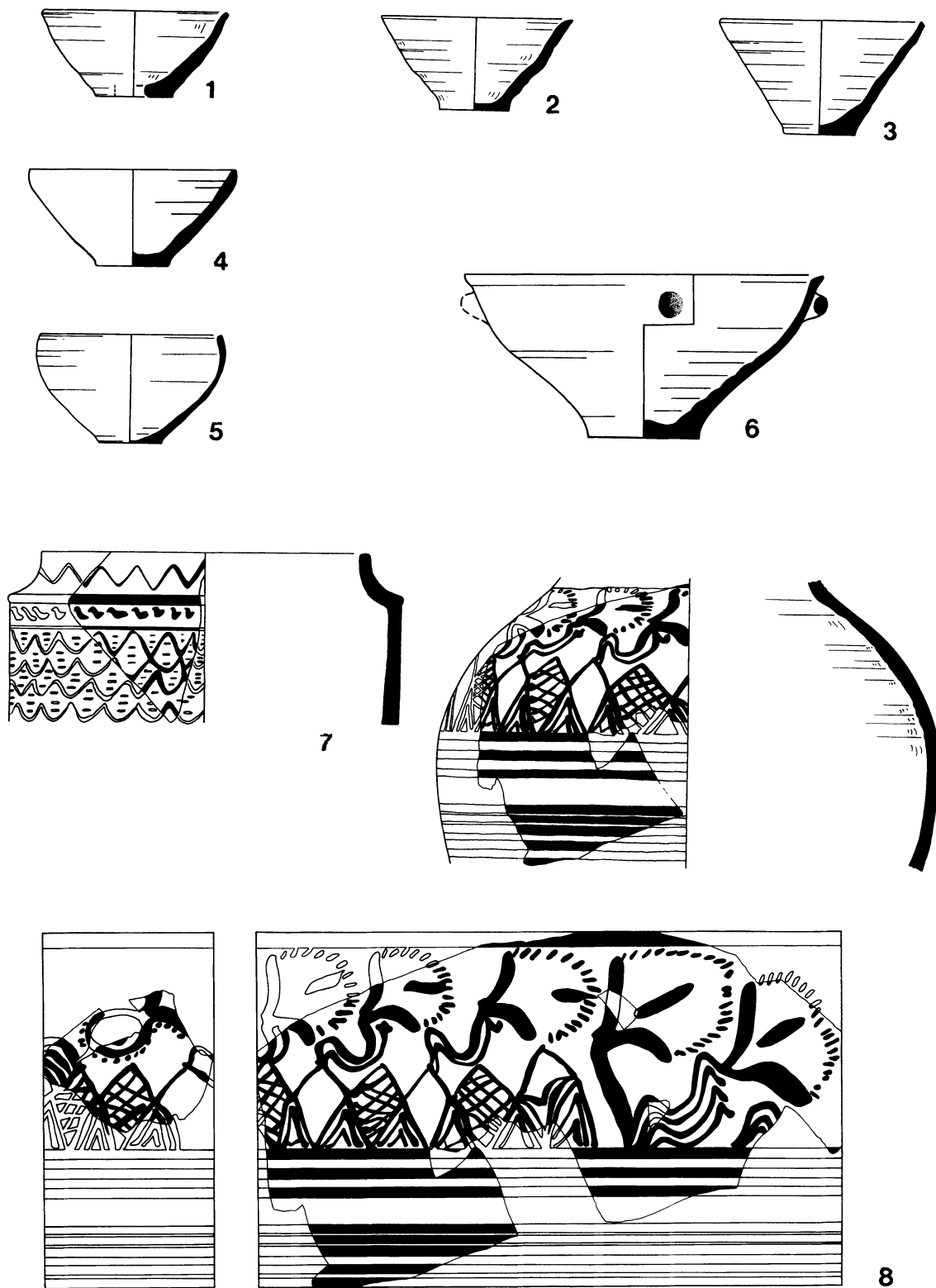


FIG. 11 LM III A1 pottery from Well 605. Scale 1/3.

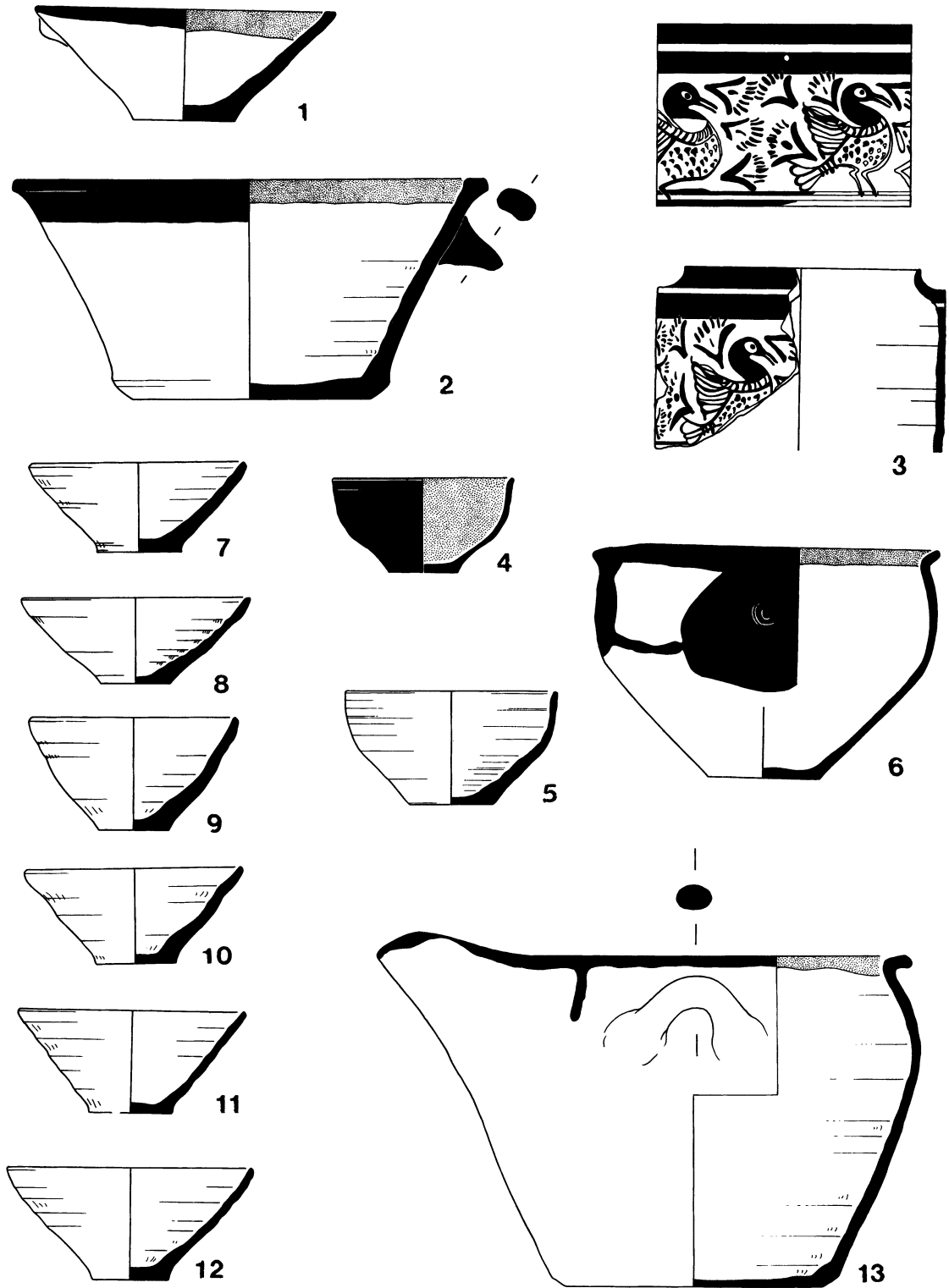


FIG. 12 LM III A1-2 pottery from Well 605. Scale 1/3.

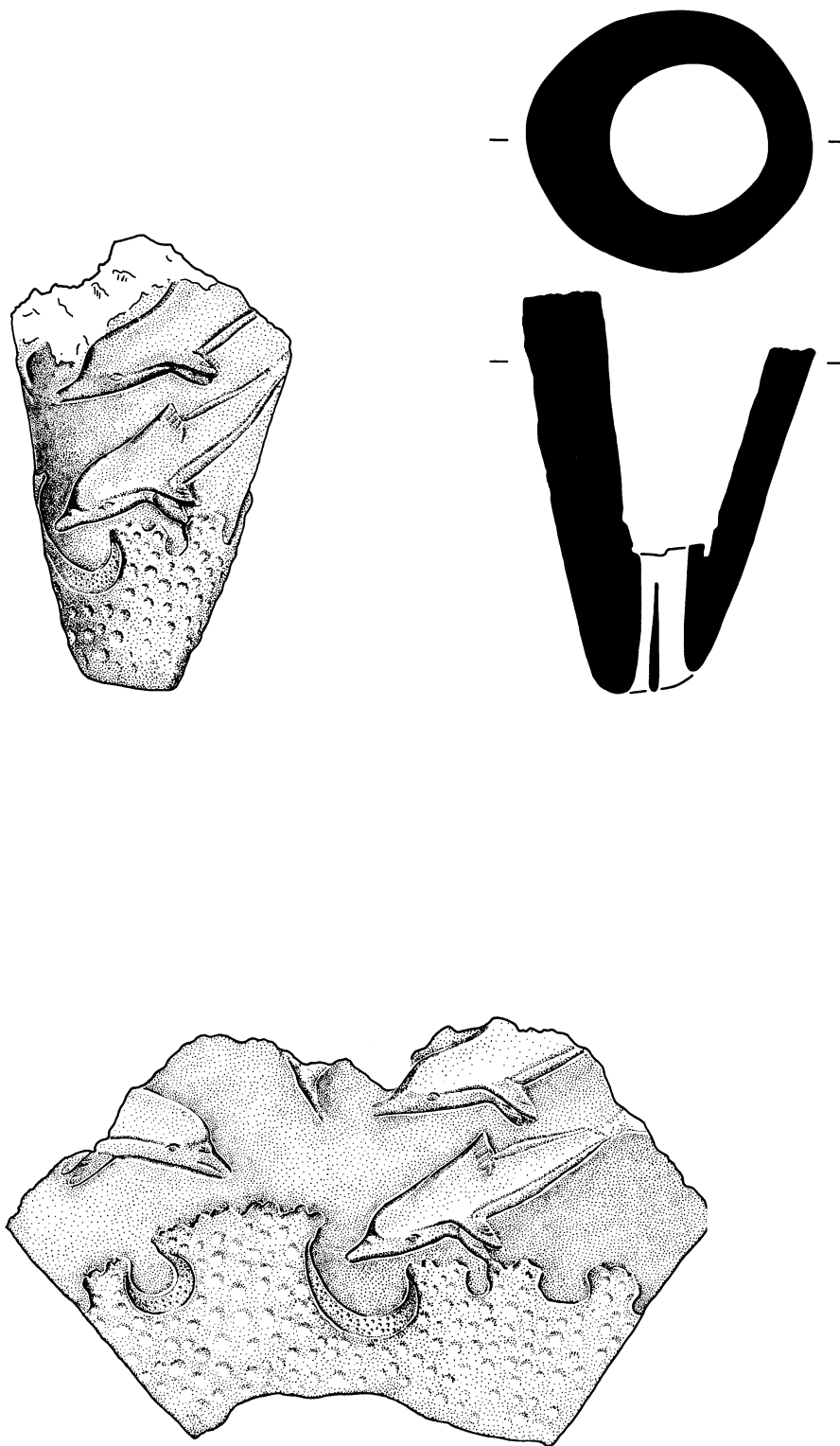


FIG. 13 Stone rhyton fragment with dolphins, from Well 605. Scale 1/3.

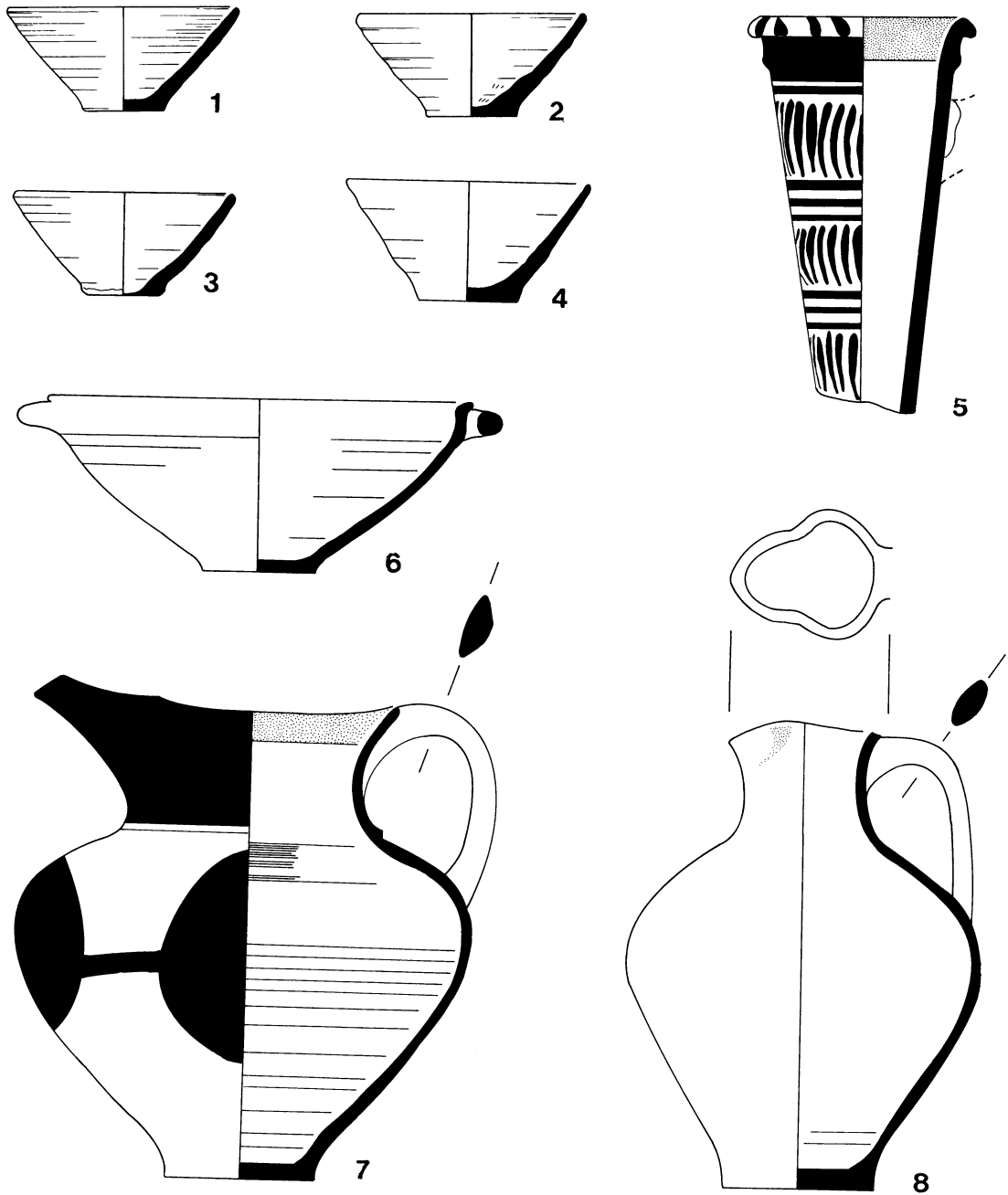


FIG. 14 LM III pottery from Well 576. Scale 1/3.

adjacent to Main Street. A feature of particular note was the architect's use of stone of different colours for paving, piers, column bases, and perhaps upper paving. Excavation in 1994 generally proceeded no deeper than the upper earth floors, which were characterized by scattered early LM I A deposits, a destruction deposit occurring only in the area of Room E,¹⁸ and this was taken to confirm the two previous seasons' findings that this was the building's final period of use. That this was early in the period was indicated by evidence for abandonment and deliberate dismantling before the deposition of pockets of Thera ash in hollows remaining in the abandoned ruins.¹⁹ A particular problem for the reconstruction of the plan was the fact that severe erosion at the north side of the building had left nothing later than MM III B deposits to date this part of the structure.

It seemed worthwhile to include this summary of the first three seasons' work (1991–2, 1994), at the risk of some repetition of the detailed accounts below of the stratigraphical contexts (J.A.M.) and of the architecture (J.M.D.), which bring us up to date in 1997—because of the perspective it gives on the evolving nature of the problems faced by the excavators and of the changing questions we were trying to answer. If the major problem in 1994 was to relate the south elements of the building (and their LM I A deposits) with the north sector (where only earlier deposits survived), in 1996 the central problem shifted to one of identifying the building's major construction phase (within the early Neopalatial period), among a plethora of dated contexts.

THE ARCHAEOLOGICAL CONTEXTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL SEQUENCE

BY J. A. MACGILLIVRAY

While much of the detailed history of the area remains to be clarified by study and further trials, conclusions of a general nature may be drawn from clearly dated primary deposits and a succession of cumulative deposits in some of the undisturbed rooms, particularly those cleared in 1996.

MM II

A floor with a succession of thin coats of red-orange plaster was discovered at 10.63⁺ in a trial at the southwest corner of the colonnade or stoa, shown on the aerial photo at PLATES 38–39 and the view at PLATE 47 *a* (left foreground). No other artefacts were associated, but the technique and type of plaster is so similar to the MM II floors in EQ-ER 87²⁰ that it seems safe to place the early floor beneath the stoa in the same time-period, particularly as the packing material overlying the latest floor contains a great deal of MM I and MM II pottery, though worn and fragmentary. The well-built drain in ES 81 should also be linked to this horizon.²¹

Further evidence for occupation of the area in MM II comes from a burnt destruction deposit associated with a possible early entrance on the north side of the building. Though its relationship to the main rooms of the building has yet to be clarified, it seems to indicate the presence of a substantial structure beneath the northern side of the otherwise MM III period building. The pottery in the deposit includes cups and a bridge-spouted jar in types found in

¹⁸ Here an unburnt destruction deposit excavated in 1991 (Trench EP83) and associated with stone tumble had again suggested earthquake destruction (*PK* 1991, 128–9, fig. 7; cf. *PK* 1990, 135–7).

¹⁹ Reported on for the AIA at Atlanta (*AJA* 99 (1995), 312), and for the BSA at London (*BICS* 1995).

²⁰ *PK* 1990, 133.

²¹ *PK* 1991, 125, pl. 4 *c*.

the destruction deposits that are taken to mark the end of the MM II A period at Knossos.²² A terracotta representation of a male figure in the deposit seems to have been fixed to the surface of a vase in the Plastic Style of pottery and so may be a rare instance of a human image used where animals are the common motif.²³

A group of redeposited material used to raise the floor level of storeroom R₁ at the south-east corner of the building comprises much pottery in MM II A forms and styles, but is associated with a bridge-spouted jug of a type most typical of the end of the MM II period at Malia,²⁴ apparently set as a foundation deposit beneath the east wall in the space. This is suggestive of a building programme during or towards the end of the MM II B period. The deposit also contained a terracotta figurine, quite similar to the female types with 'Medici' collar known from Petsophas,²⁵ but seemingly here part of a larger composition or an affix to a vase and thus in the MM IB and MM II A Plastic Style of Palaikastro.²⁶

MM III A

The basement rooms, B, C, D, E, and L were certainly in use by the early MM III period as rather early floor deposits were found at varying levels. The earliest floor in Room B at 10.45[^] was identified in a trial at the south end of the room, although there may have been some disturbance from successive subsequent rebuilds of the street façade.

Room C may have functioned as a support for a stairway. A foundation deposit at the north end of C comprised a bridge-spouted jar of MM III type.

The earliest occupation in Rooms D₁–2 and E₁ is represented by burnt destruction deposits on earth floors at 10.40[^] to 10.60[^]. The pottery consists mainly of fine shallow bowls and goblets of early MM III type, but includes a fine cup decorated in a style quite similar to that on a cup and rhyton from the very end of the MM II B period or early in MM III A at Knossos (FIG. 15).²⁷ The form of the cup is very similar to one found in a tomb at Kharji in Beirut, which may now be placed at the end of the Old Palace period.²⁸

The earliest floor in Room L₁–2 is a very fine example of 'mosaiko' paving with schist slabs outlined in white plaster at 10.20[^]. The north wall of the room in the earliest phase has not been fully clarified, as it must underlie later rebuilding; however, the northern part of the paved floor comprises a partially sunken rectangular feature, c.0.10 m lower than the rest of the room except at the west end where the corner rises to meet the floor level forming a trough apparently intended to direct liquids from a possible installation, now obscured by the collapse of the west wall. The function of the paved room and sunken feature could not be determined through finds, though the presence of faint traces of a deep red pigment at a few spots near the inlet may indicate a relationship to the murex-purple dye industry, for which evidence in the form of numerous crushed shells has been found to the west of the room associated with MM III pottery.²⁹ The construction date of the floor cannot be placed with precision as it seems to have been laid out on sterile soil, but the earliest deposit, a mixture of stone and rubble, includes pottery quite similar to that on the earliest floors in Rooms D₁–3 and so seems to belong to a stage of the MM III A period. Fragments of painted plaster found throughout the lowest level appear to come from a collapsed

²² J. A. MacGillivray, *Knossos: Pottery Groups of the Old Palace Period* (BSA Studies, forthcoming).

²³ PKU, 12, pls. vi d, vii.

²⁴ J.-C. Poursat, *Artisans minoens: les maisons-ateliers du Quartier Mu* (Études Crétoises 32, 1996), 66, pl. 331.

²⁵ PK II, 368, pl. 8.

²⁶ PKU, 12, pls. vi d, vii.

²⁷ MacGillivray (n. 22).

²⁸ P. Warren and V. Hankey, *Aegean Bronze Age Chronology* (Bristol, 1989), 134–5, pl. 12 a.

²⁹ PK 1991, 126.

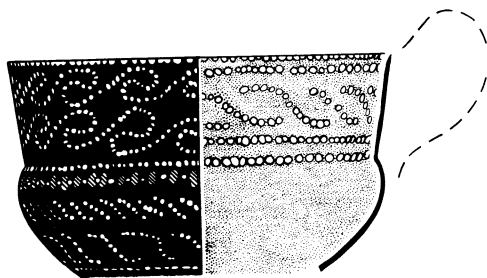


FIG. 15 Fine polychrome decorated cup from Room E1, 96/5938. Scale 1/2.

stair in the south-east corner, the bottom two steps of which were preserved. Some of the plaster was decorated with a red monochrome paint on to which was applied white lines to give a marbling effect, perhaps to suggest a revetment in a red and white marble like that in the nearby quarries at Vai exploited during the Roman period. The use of wall plaster decorated to resemble stone revetments is well known from Cretan Neopalatial architecture, perhaps the closest parallels in style and date being from Khania,³⁰ Petras and Knossos.

The layout of courtyard H with paving slabs seems most likely to belong to the rearrangement of the area following the MM II A destruction, as the pottery from a trial beneath the south-west corner of the court produced worn pottery in MM I B and IIA forms and styles. However, it could also belong after the MM III A event and thus be a feature put into place early in the MM III B period; future trials will be necessary to determine the exact construction date of the paving and probably also the colonnade and pier-and-door partition.

MM III B

The deposits we take to mark the end of the MM III A period seem to indicate an event in the building's history that caused the west wall of Room L to collapse. The room was then subdivided by a small roughly built wall which allowed the east end of the room, L3, to remain in use while the west, L1, seems to have been filled in. Under the south-west corner of the dividing wall a shallow bowl of early MM III type was placed as a foundation deposit, and nearby was found a spouted tripod cooking-pot.

The end of this period is marked by two horizons; the second following the first quite closely. The first is composed of thin successive layers of compacted silt, or *νερόχωμα*, apparently built up through the action of water entering the rooms and forming rather thick layers. Little occupation debris is associated with these layers, rather we imagine the inhabitants to have occupied the first floor during what may have been one or more particularly wet seasons. Directly on top of the silt layers fell destruction debris including building materials and pottery. A similar sequence was found in rooms D1 and 2, E1, and L1 and 3.

The splitting and collapse of the upper part of the west wall in room L and the collapse of the wall and doorway at the building's north entrance (at N), where it was mixed with a tumble of artefacts forming one of the primary pottery deposits, are associated with what seems to have been a major seismic event. A small cupboard in Room R1 contained cooking

³⁰ M. Andreadaki-Vlasaki, 'Sunken or "lustral basin" in Khania', *AAA* 21 (1988), 56–76.

pots, jugs, and a host of straight-sided cups, shallow bowls, and rounded goblets. Many had been stacked, some on a plaster shelf, at the time of the room's collapse and burial, PLATE 46 c, very much like the fine wares in a contemporary deposit in Building 2 Room 2.³¹

The pottery includes local MM III B styles as defined by Bernini,³² and central Cretan imports in the form of cups and bowls decorated with large white interlocking S-spirals on a dark monochrome ground allow us to link the event we use here to define the end of the MM III B period at Palaikastro quite closely to a similar event at Knossos³³ and the early seismic event at Akrotiri in Thera.³⁴ The association of the silt layers with the seismic event may be linked to the climatological event signalled by the increased tree ring growths.³⁵ If this is the case, the silt layers could be the first evidence for the climatic event of 1628 BC, which would not be part of the Thera eruption, as has been suggested, but rather earlier.

LM I A

A building operation in the western rooms included the use of great quantities of material from the recent destruction to raise the floor levels in Rooms D and E. Most of the pottery is in styles and types of the MM III B period, but includes a small number of pieces in the Bichrome Style of LM I A. The mixture of pottery of both MM III B and LM I A types and styles is very similar to that found in a number of areas in Building 13³⁶ and to a deposit from the town of Knossos.³⁷

Floors at c.10.80–10.90⁺ in Rooms B and L are of hard beaten earth with some stone slabs and are now reached by breaches in the north wall of room B and east wall of room L, entrances which are supplied with rough steps of blue limestone, perhaps pulled from the paved court, now apparently derelict.

The end of this period is marked at a number of locations by layers of water-borne volcanic ash from the Minoan eruption of Thera, directly associated with a rounded cup with medallion spirals of the LM I A period in Room B. The accumulation in the LM I A surface of Main Street,³⁸ like that found adjacent to Building 7,³⁹ and in Drain J leave little doubt that the ash was deposited gradually through the action of water and allowed to collect in pools where it lay undisturbed, as illustrated in the drawn section over Drain J (FIG. 16).⁴⁰ This seems

³¹ PK 1986, 150–1, pl. 24 c, d, e.

³² L. Bernini, 'Ceramics of the early neo-palatial period at Palaikastro', *BSA* 90 (1995), 59–61, fig. 7.

³³ M. S. F. Hood, 'Back to basics with MMIIIB', in D. Evelyn, I. S. Lemos, and S. Sherratt (eds), *Minotaur and Centaur: Studies Presented to Mervyn Popham* (BAR S638, 1996) 10; C. F. Macdonald, 'Notes on some LM I A contexts from Knossos', *ibid.* 17.

³⁴ M. Marthari, 'The destruction of the town at Akrotiri, Thera at the beginning of LC I: definition and chronology', in J. A. MacGillivray and R. L. N. Barber (eds), *The Prehistoric Cyclades* (Edinburgh, 1984), 119–33.

³⁵ See P. Kuniholm *et al.*, 'Anatolian tree rings and the absolute chronology of the Eastern Mediterranean 2220–718 BC', *Nature*, 381 (27 June 1996), 782.

³⁶ Bernini (n. 32), 62.

³⁷ P. M. Warren, 'A new Minoan deposit from Knossos, c.1600 BC, and its wider relations', *BSA* 86 (1991), 319–40.

³⁸ Discussed in detail below by Eleni Hatzaki.

³⁹ PK 1991, 137.

⁴⁰ As we interpret this, level 10 represents an early compact stony fill, predating the building. There followed a period of construction in quite grand style, represented here by the built

drain, stone-lined and originally covered too. Levels 7, 8, and 9 represent silt, fill, and debris which accumulated after the events (perhaps seismic) which caused the demolition of the building and indeed after the demolition itself. There followed a powerful run-off of water cutting a course immediately parallel to but north of the now clogged drain. This is shown by the hollow later filled by levels 3–6. The fill was a build-up of alluvium, first a layer of fairly pure silt, then a sequence of wash levels containing lenses of tiny waterborne pebbles and some tephra perhaps deriving either from a first fall or from the later deposit lying immediately above (levels 5 and 6). Over this was found a layer of whitish volcanic ash, compact, horizontally layered, with larger pumice pieces at the bottom, finer ash at the top, and mixed at its upper limits with thin striations of mud again lying flat and evidently due to a sequence of rain-water puddles. Although analysis is still pending at the time of writing, it seems clear that this material should be associated with the Minoan eruption of Thera. Above this lay a thick and compact layer of orange-yellow clay (2), a wash level found close below the surface and containing nothing later than LM I A ceramic material, a factor consistent with our interpretation of this as an open area in the succeeding periods.

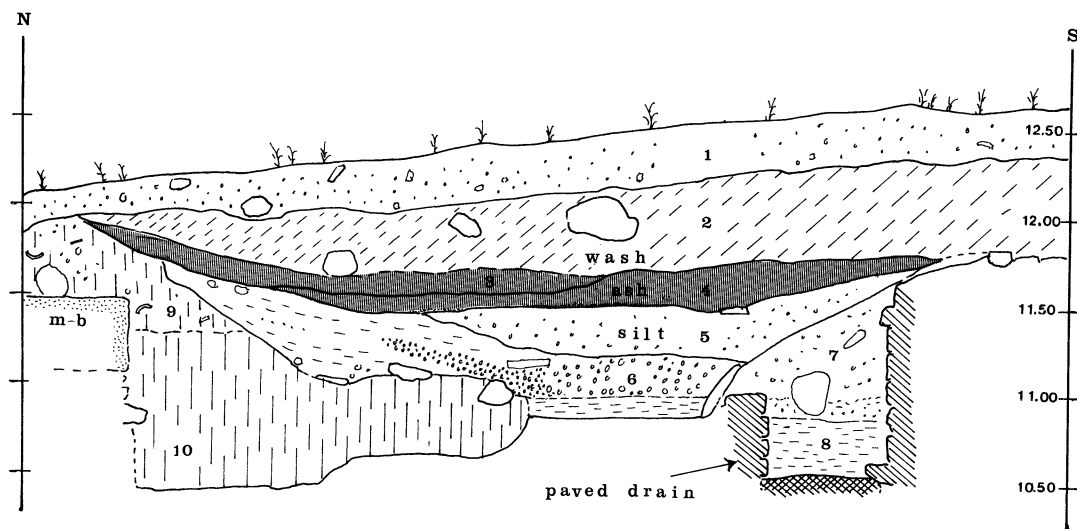


FIG. 16 East section at Drain (J), showing tephra deposit: 1. Surface soil: crumbly plough soil and wash from 1904 dump. 2. Hard compact orange-yellow clay; LM I A wash level. 3–6 Accumulated layers of fill in water-cut channel; LM I A, post-demolition. 3. Layered whitish volcanic ash, mixed with fine silted earth (rain wash). 4. Pure whitish volcanic ash, with fine pumice. 5. Silty earth and lenses of tiny pebbles; water-borne. 6. Alluvial fill; fairly soft clay and some tephra, with lenses of pebbly wash. 7. Silt with pebbles and building debris (building abandoned). 8. Pure silt in channel of paved drain. 9. Pebbly fill with building debris, sherds, carbon. 10. Hard pebbly fill.

to indicate another climatic event, this time following closely on from the Minoan eruption of Thera. That the ash was deposited in a similar way in Rooms B, D, L, and M strongly suggests that these rooms were largely out of use and no longer had roofs by the end of the LM I A period. It seems most likely that the building was derelict and had been looted of building materials when the ash fell. It may have suffered so greatly during the seismic event at the end of the MM III B period that it was never fully reused. In any case, occupation in the LM I A period seems to have been sparse, though the removal of building materials and other artefacts prior to the ash horizon could account for an image of abandonment.

LM I B

There is no evidence for habitation structures in the area of Building 6 during the LM I B period, so fully illustrated by the monuments that surround the area. Instead, the only activity to leave its trace was the digging and use of two wells, 576 and 605, a selection of whose contents are illustrated at FIGS. 6–9.

LM II

Main Street was rebuilt on the old Neopalatial line during or after the LM II period, as the latest material from the packing layer beneath the latest surface indicates. This is reported on by Eleni Hatzaki below. The new surface was fine sandstone slabs extending fully to the South Façade of Building 6, but leaving a drain or 'gutter' on the south side.

The remains of a floor at c.11.35⁺ in Room D provided a primary deposit including a double vase with plastic bird on the spout, FIG. 17. The vase is very similar in form and style to

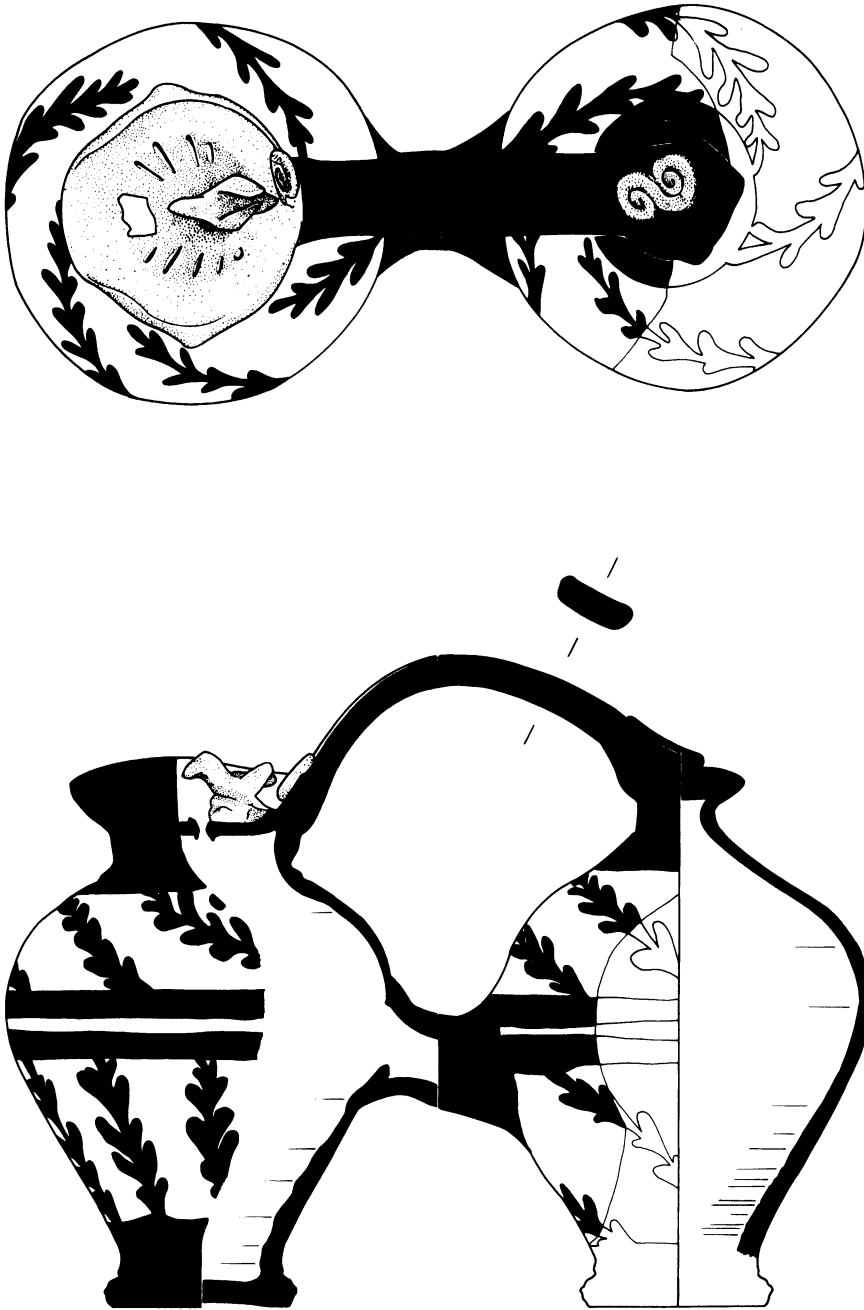


FIG. 17 Twin vase (LM II/III A1) from stratum overlying Room D1. Scale 1/2.

a group of double vases also with plastic birds from the Kamilari Tholos, assigned to Levi's Phaistos period III.⁴¹ However, the Kamilari tholos was in use over a very long period ending in LM III A2,⁴² the date of a similar double-vase with plastic bird from Chania.⁴³ A double vase very similar to the one in Room D also with plastic birds set at the rim of the spout above the strainer was found in tomb A at Katsambas along with other vases of the LM II period.⁴⁴ Other double vases from Palaikastro belong to the LM I B–LM III period.⁴⁵ The decoration on our piece most closely resembles the diagonal vegetal motifs common on pottery in the LM II destruction deposits at the Unexplored Mansion at Knossos.⁴⁶ The double-vase and therefore the floor and wall seem most likely to belong to the LM II or LM III A1 periods, and thus could be part of the re-establishing of Main Street and the defining of the walls around Area 6 in LM II. The plastic bird, the date and the context, directly opposite the entrance to Block Delta may indicate a relationship between the use of Area 6 after the LM I B period and the small LM III A1 shrine with the 'doves' and group of lyre-player and dancers in δ44.⁴⁷

THE ARCHITECTURE BY J. M. DRIESSEN

As indicated in the introductory summary above, the prime remains are formed by the South-East Building complex, comprising (as known so far) a small court surrounded by some fifteen rooms or spaces. These are designated alphabetically for reference to the plan at FIG. 2.

A DEFINITION OF THE AREA: THE FAÇADES

The area of Building 6 is delimited by Main Street at the south, by its north-running branch (adjacent to Block B) at the east, and by the alley 5/6 at the north, whereas the western limit has not yet become clear. A preliminary discussion of the actual state of the façade walls at once highlights the complicated nature of the architectural remains, owing to a variety of factors, including a sequence of destructions, rebuildings, deliberate robbing, erosion, and earlier archaeological work. The seriousness of the situation is illustrated by the fact that almost without exception the interior partition walls cannot be associated with the surface remains of the exterior façades (which are later), though there is little doubt that the original façades did run on approximately the same lines.

THE SOUTH FAÇADE

The South Façade at Main Street, where best preserved, is clearly a rebuild of the original line. There are traces of three phases in this wall line, and they can be related to three successive paved surfaces of Main Street.⁴⁸ First, from the inner face at Room B one can see four courses of the original foundations (W.o.90 m) set on bedrock.⁴⁹ But on top of this a

⁴¹ D. Levi, 'La tomba a tholos di Kamilari a Festòs', *ASA* 39–40 (1961–2), 37, fig. 35; D. Levi and F. Carinci, *Festòs e la civiltà minoica II* (Rome, 1988), 107–8, pl. 48 c–f.

⁴² A. Kanta, *The Late Minoan III Period in Crete* (SIMA 58; Göteborg, 1980), 101–2.

⁴³ B. P. Hallager and P. J. P. McGeorge, *Late Minoan III Burials at Khania* (SIMA 93; Göteborg, 1992), 19, pl. 17 a, b, 18 a P 6339.

⁴⁴ S. Alexiou, 'Υστερομινωϊκοὶ τάφοι λιμένος Κνωσού (Κατσαμπά)' (Athens, 1967), 42, 61, pls. 7 a–b, 9 a–b.

⁴⁵ *PKU* 62, 110 and 160.

⁴⁶ M. R. Popham, *The Minoan Unexplored Mansion at Knossos* (Oxford, 1984), pl. 165, nos. 37–9.

⁴⁷ *PK* III, 217–22, fig. 6.

⁴⁸ The phases are clearest at the test made through the street surface in the area of Room B, and are discussed in greater detail below by Eleni Hatzaki.

⁴⁹ These are not found further east, at Room P, where the early wall line must have been set slightly further south, for the LM I A pebble and plaster floor runs directly beneath the later rebuild.

rebuild (W.o.60, H.pres. 0.44 m), in places separated by a thin earth layer but in others indistinguishable. It displays an exterior face at Main Street of well-shaped rectangular Cape Sidero blocks, surviving one course high (H. of course 0.20 m, surface at 11.80[^]), backed by small field stones and probably once supporting an ashlar sandstone (ammoudha) superstructure⁵⁰ (PLATE 46 *a*, right foreground). The early foundations should go with the newly revealed first road surface of sandstone (MM III and to early LM I A), whose drain became filled with volcanic ash. The second-phase façade surviving today at the level of the street surface must post-date the use of the building and the robbing out of the original wall, since the inner partition walls stop short of its structure. It may be assigned to the LM I B boundary wall for the open area of this period, since it was already in place before the drain was filled and packed for the later (LM II–III A) sandstone-paved street surface. In the stratigraphy of the street there is an intermediate surface of schist paving at 11.60[^] which can be related to this façade. Of the later (LM II–III A) wall line there are traces to the east, where the second-phase façade was robbed out and later replaced. The fragment of an oblique wall running over Room D₁, though out of line, should be associated with this final façade, since it is dated LM II–III A₁ by the deposit with twin vase which was found against it. It is tempting also to associate with it the wide entrance to Block M shown on the 1905 plan, starting at the west side of this oblique wall, and including a massive Cape Sidero slab as a possible threshold block.⁵¹

THE EAST FAÇADE

There are two easily distinguishable phases in the East Façade. This is clear at the south part of the building, where the original line (W.o.85, max. H.o.65) lay c.1.0 m to the west of the later line.⁵² At Room R₁ a test revealed a MM II B–MM III A foundation deposit for the original wall, and a MM III B deposit was found resting against the wall itself, giving dates of construction and use consistent with those deduced for the first phase of the South Façade. At Rooms P and Q the early façade wall does not survive above floor level, but is bonded in with the north walls of these rooms and seems to belong with the traces of plaster and pebble floors found here whose final use was in the LM I A period.⁵³ The later rebuild (W.o.80–85, max. H.o.70) contains reused blocks, including a massive corner-stone which links it with the LM II–III A South Façade, but it had been cleared (and possibly reconstructed?) during Bosanquet's excavations, and so firm dating evidence is lacking.

As the East Façade continues north, through ET84, it is constructed more massively (one stone measures W.o.75, H.o.70). But excavation here has not proceeded below the level reached by Bosanquet, and no significant new information is yet available. The link with the north terrace wall running west to Room N awaits further investigation.

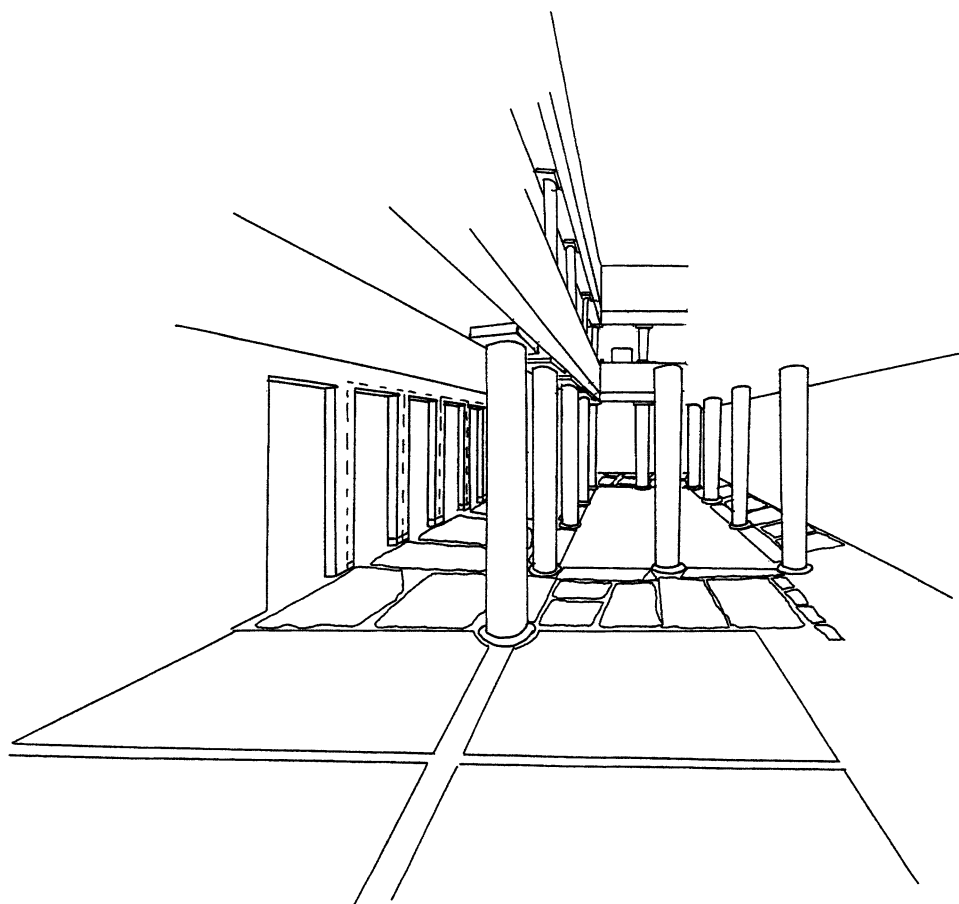
⁵⁰ These Cape Sidero blocks are not preserved in a continuous line along the south façade. Alongside Room A they were robbed out, as is made clear by the presence of stone chips and the erratic position of the stones which later filled the robbing trench. The line continues past Rooms B–D but in less regular shape and partly in different materials, though the robbing is not so easily determined. The sideropetra line does continue further west (fronting the southwest sector of Building 6 at EJ/EN 82/84), but there is set c.0.30 m higher.

⁵¹ The slab is broken and fragmentary, but measures 0.56

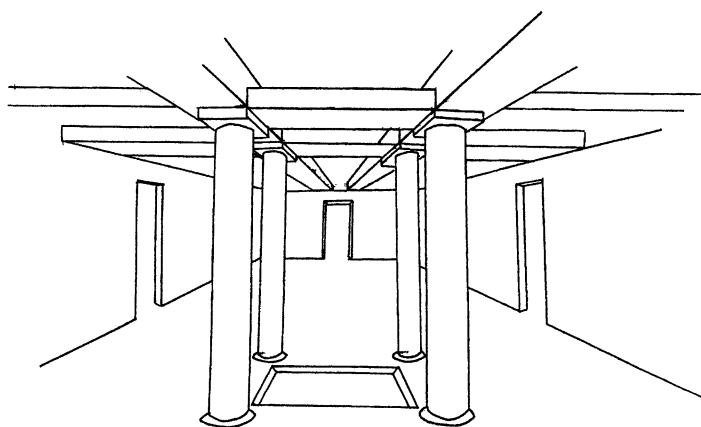
(E–W) × 0.67 (N–S) × 0.27 m, and resembles the LM III A threshold slab of Building 1.

⁵² The two lines merge further north and are not yet distinguished, nor is the relationship with the exterior wall of Room K clear. The curving wall shown derives from the 1904 excavation plan, and could be a later modification of an original squared corner. Its line lies outside the permitted excavation area.

⁵³ In Room Q the edge of the plaster floor runs along the wall line and suggests a superstructure of mud-brick here.



(a)



(b)

FIG. 18 Reconstruction of two contrasting types of Minoan Hall, (a) Building 6, (b) the standard Palaikastro Hall. (Copyright JMD).

THE NORTH FAÇADE AND THE NORTH TERRACE WALL

The North Façade at the alleyway separating Buildings 5 and 7 from Building 6 was revealed in 1990. Its upper courses defined the alley during the LM III periods, when the street level was high and ran above massive LM I B destruction deposits. In the LM I B period the same line served as a terrace wall for the higher open ground on the south (Building 6) side. This is shown by earth layers with ogival cups at both the east and west ends of Building 6 which ran up against the North Façade wall at a level as much as 1 m higher than the LM I street surface. The north sector of Building 6 had no interior partition walls at this time. However, where excavation has reached the LM I A levels (in the north-west sector of Building 6) it is clear that a paved way of access on level ground entered the area from the street, but was subsequently blocked off (see discussion of the West Zone of Building 6 above). At that time the rise in ground level was some 10 m further south (where steps led up from a paved court), while further east the North Terrace Wall formed a massive support for the northern rooms and the court of the main part of Building 6, at least in its later phases (MM III B–LM I A). Their floors were laid down over 1 m higher, founded on a vast levelling fill, up to 1.40 m deep in places.⁵⁴ The North Terrace Wall is 0.75–1.0 m thick and is strongly constructed of large and medium-sized stones. A narrow doorway, c.0.75 m wide led south through the wall to an unexcavated area, deep beneath the later floor packing, an area that is characterized by stone fall and other earthquake debris. It seems likely that a catastrophic event caused the entrance to be abandoned, walled up, and later built over during the MM III period. MM III B destruction deposits are associated with the wall and cover the door blocking at a higher level. There is also evidence for two earlier construction phases in the eastern part of this area: the first is a plaster floor with strong foundation of yellow clay, laid down at 9.45⁺, close above red virgin soil and having an associated burnt destruction deposit of MM II A character (see discussion of MM II deposits above); the second comprises an area of schist paving laid quite closely over this, with two associated wall fragments, set about 1.45 m apart, running out at right angles from the North Terrace Wall. Their masonry stands 35–45 cm high where it was later incorporated into the fabric of the terrace wall by its builders.

THE WESTERN LIMITS OF THE AREA AND THE WEST FAÇADE OF BUILDING 6

While no western limit has yet been found for the partly excavated MM III and LM I A structures to the west,⁵⁵ the North Façade does turn south at the corner of 'Harbour Road' in a strongly built line of LM III construction, probably on LM I B foundations at its north end—a line that may well represent the western limit of the delimited open area from LM I B onwards. But the West Façade of Building 6 at Rooms D1–L1 is a strongly constructed terrace wall built to retain the higher ground at the west and 0.75–1.0 m thick at the top of its latest rebuild. Owing probably to earth pressure and earthquake disturbance, this wall suffered continual damage and collapse,⁵⁶ and was rebuilt a number of times (MM III B, LM I A, LM I B, and LM II–III A) with the result that the original (MM III A) line is almost totally obscured. Two courses of rather small stones at the west of Room L1 indicate its line—a line

⁵⁴ This is consistent with the general downhill slope of the terrain from SW to NE. There is a drop of nearly 2 m from Main Street, where bedrock is found at 11.16 m, to Building VII, where it is at c.9.50 m.

⁵⁵ See n.9.

⁵⁶ The damage was on one occasion so severe that the plane of the outer face of the wall came to rest inside (east of) the original plane of its inner face—apparently shifted bodily (as an unbroken unit) by earthquake. The erratic, sinuous, line of what remains at the surface is shown on the air photo in PLATES 38–39.

which was more or less kept by the MM III B rebuild, visible in four courses of medium-sized stones. The upper surface of these is level with that of the added cross-wall which subdivides Room L, and should be contemporary (MM III B). The indentation in its line at Room L2 should also be contemporary and may be part of a repair to structural damage. Certainly two masses of fallen masonry at the east and west sides of Room L3 resemble earthquake damage of this period. It is also possible that the oblique wall subdividing Room L was built to retain a now unmanageable mass of fallen masonry from the West Façade. The association of earthquake damage with MM III B deposits in a number of different areas and their stratification over some 5–15 cm of waterborne silt, suggestive of serious flooding is discussed above.

The uppermost rebuild of the West Façade is constructed of boulder-like stones, including conglomerate lumps, two to three courses high, and may have functioned as a field wall, perhaps contemporary with the latest use of Well 576 and unconnected with the building.

A POSSIBLE ENTRANCE HALL OR PROPYLON AT G

The most prominent surviving feature of Building 6 is a regular, almost square area, paved with four very large calcareous sandstone (ammoudha) slabs, and of overall dimensions 3.60×4.50 m as restored on plan in FIGS. 2–3 (restoration PLATE 40). The slabs are of soft and friable stone, only 10–12 cm thick at the edges, and are badly eroded.⁵⁷ None survives intact, and each in fact consisted of two cut pieces, a larger and a smaller, tightly juxtaposed. The north-east slab measures 165×180 –2 cm, has well-cut edges and is bedded on a layer of sand 8 cm thick over a deep fill. The south-east slab, now badly eroded, originally measured 163×183 cm. Traces of the north-west slab, now almost totally destroyed, give dimensions of $c.155 \times 180$ cm, while the south-west slab is better preserved and of dimensions 169×242 cm. Gaps were left in between these four slabs, forming a cross reminiscent of the plastered cross found in Room 66 of Block Chi.⁵⁸ Although no traces of plaster survive in the divisions between these slabs, it seems probable that the gaps were filled by plastered beams of wood, for there are bands of pinkish plaster on the north, east, and west sides $c.19$ cm wide and with a vertical edge 8 cm deep, going down below the base of the slabs. These would have formed a frame for the whole platform, with cross at centre. It is also possible that there were two construction phases here and that some of the plastered surfaces relate to an earlier phase, since some sideropetra slabs of the court paving had been set against a previously laid plaster face.

The south-west slab, and undoubtedly also the north-west slab (now lost), were cut in a curve to receive a large column base formed from a grey-green Cape Sidero slab (FIG. 3). The base, left rough at its centre to receive the column, measures 68 cm in diameter and is still covered on one side by a protective pebble and plaster band 10 cm wide and 4 cm high (PLATE 44 *a–b*), which brought the slightly lower level of the base up to that of the sandstone slabs.

The 'Entrance Hall' was limited at the north by a wall 65–75 cm wide separating it from the drain area (Room J); it was limited at the south by a plastered wall 53 cm wide and preserved only $c.15$ to 20 cm high, but based on an earlier wall, for its plastered south face continues

⁵⁷ Continued deterioration after exposure in 1994, especially as a result of two bouts of immersion in seasonal winter flooding, made it clear that drastic conservation was necessary. This was carried out by the Knossian workmen under Pamela Jerome's supervision, during the summer of 1996 in a fully reversible

manner by covering the slabs with sand and placing concrete replicas of slabs and plastered beams above. An attempt was made to reproduce the original colour variation (red and yellow). The restoration is seen in the views at PLATE 40.

⁵⁸ PK IV, 278, fig. 9.

below the level of the plaster floor in the adjacent Room F. To the west it ends at the central column base fronting on to the paved court, but at the east fronts on a disturbed area (FIG. 3) where a patch of schist paving may perhaps have run over the walls associated with the MM III B cupboard at Room R1 (FIG. 2), which seems to imply a late date or a rebuild for this part of the layout. One limestone slab with surface at a height of 11.40 m, flush with the plastered border and only c.5 cm higher, may represent a columned front on this side⁵⁹ (FIG. 3).

Thus we may reconstruct a rectangular space at least 5.50 m east–west by 3.50 m north–south, with two side walls to north and south, perhaps a pillar base to the east and a column to the west. If this is interpreted as an entrance hall it could be likened in a general sense to those in the palaces, although on a much less grand scale.⁶⁰

THE COLONNADED COURT

The ‘Entrance Hall’ at G leads to an open court measuring 7.30×10.70 overall, but having a central unroofed space of only 3.40×5.00 m if a covered colonnade is restored on each side. The evidence for this is of uneven quality on the different sides, discussed in greater detail below.

The boundaries of the court are clear on the south and west sides. The north wall, clear at its west end, is totally eroded away at the centre (PLATE 43 *b*, left), but must have linked up with the north-east corner preserved in ES 83 with return running south past the west end of the drain to the entrance hall G.

Two successive floor levels of pale pink plaster with blue pebbles were found over much of the central area, while fragments of a third, later, surface were noted running over the eroded footings of the destroyed north wall. No trace of a wall or other structure could be linked with the third surface, which may represent a level of eroded flooring material deposited gradually after the area’s abandonment.

On the south side of the court, paving in Cape Sidero slabs of blue limestone (with an occasional schist slab included) continues the line of the entrance hall with two large east–west slabs followed by four others placed laterally (north–south) and then two more placed east–west (FIG. 3). As the line continues further west the paving becomes less regular and this pattern suggests that the carefully arranged floor of the entrance hall combined with the more regular section of paving here served principally to direct traffic into the polythyron in Room A. The south side of the paving was undoubtedly flanked by a colonnade of which unfortunately only one column base survives (FIG. 3, PLATE 44 *a*). This base is of grey-blue limestone cut straight at the sides and with a diameter of 46 cm. It is finely worked but the upper surface was left rough at the centre to provide a better setting for the column. On the south side of its upper surface, preserved owing to slight subsidence of the base, was found a coating comprising a mixture of stone chips and plaster; in addition, a curving plaster line c.2 cm thick and surviving up to 6 cm high preserved the curve of the wooden column on the north-west half of the base. Set back c.2 cm from the north edge of the base but almost flush at the west edge, this plaster moulding along with the plaster covering at the south show that the wooden column had a diameter of c.40 cm (PLATE 44 *b*).

⁵⁹ Ideally excavation should proceed further east to reveal the building’s façade on the street fronting on Block B here, but this is disputed land, with a complex legal

history since the days of the earlier excavations.

⁶⁰ *PM* ii. 672.

The highest point of the column base is now level with the sideropetra stylobate slabs to the west of it, and it is to this level that the second of the two pebble and plaster floors runs up. Perhaps then the column base can be associated in its original bedding with the earlier of the two floors, implying that the sideropetra slabs of the stylobate are a later modification.

Immediately west of this column base a large, thick and deeply set stylobate slab had been partially levered up from its bedding, but is now restored (FIG. 3, PLATE 43 *a, c*). This is clear evidence for the deliberate dismantling of the building, probably early in the LM I A period. Beyond it a fragment of a rounded ammoudha slab is set in position where one expects the second column base (FIG. 3, PLATE 43 *a*, left foreground). This base fragment continues the direct line from the (larger) base of the propylon and again the link between the two systems is stressed. The distance between the propylon base and the first base of the colonnade is 1.75 m, but the distance between the base of the west colonnade and the next base fragment gives an intercolumniation of c.2.60 m. The width of the stylobate on the south side is 2.60 m, which is then equal to the intercolumniation of the south colonnade. Evidence for a possible upper gallery over the colonnade was slight; it included fallen rubble masonry (PLATE 43 *a, d*) and scattered fragments of pink-coloured lime plaster.

The evidence for a paved colonnade along the east side of the court is limited to a group of sideropetra slabs at the south-east corner turning in this direction, and some schist slabs with rubble foundation at the north-east corner. From these the width of this colonnade may be estimated at c.1.75 m.

If the restoration of a colonnade on these two sides is accepted, it seems likely that it continued on the north and west sides also. The evidence here is again quite limited, but on the west side there is a band of irregular bedding up to 1.30 m wide, with the remains of Cape Sidero paving running c.1.20 m north from the line of the south colonnade, while on the north side a similar band of stone bedding c.1.30 m wide runs out from the north-west corner, petering out further east due to erosion; one Cape Sidero slab remains *in situ* near the north-west corner (52 × 20 × 7 cm). It may be noted further that the make-up of these bands of stone bedding round the north-east perimeter of the court is quite distinct from the finer clay base for the plaster and pebble floor of the central area, and that this in itself had suggested a paved perimeter before any of the more conclusive evidence on the south side had come to light.

The north and east walls of the court are poorly preserved: little more than one course survives anywhere, door-jambs and thresholds are missing, and the long north wall, comparatively well built at its western end (c.55 cm wide), is robbed or eroded to its foundations for most of its length. On its north side the line of its lost edge is shown by the remains of the plaster floor of the adjacent room (Room M).

A sounding to earlier levels was made through the court floor, at the south-west corner of the colonnade where the paving slabs were less well preserved. Here the plaster face of the south wall continued 2–3 cm below the surface of the slabs (as was true of the sandstone slabs of the porch, Room G), showing that the wall had been plastered before the laying of the slabs, but this could be an indication of constructional practice rather than of a chronological gap. Below the slabs a pebble and earth fill some 50 cm deep covered lines of stone walling which served as strengthening buttresses against both the south and the west walls, and over an earlier floor at 10.63⁺ on which they rested. This floor was set on a thick clay bedding (Th. c.15 cm) close over red sterile earth, and was surfaced with good yellow plaster. The scanty remains of associated wall lines formed a T-shape but had been demolished leaving only c.20 cm of foundations below floor level, and the test area was too

small to clarify their function.⁶¹ In the discussion of deposits given above a MM II date is suggested for this earlier construction. Further testing may make it possible to relate it to the plastered mud-brick steps which rise from the earliest construction of Room L3 to the same level (top step at 10.60⁺),⁶² and to see it as part of a predecessor to the colonnaded central court.

In summary it is suggested that the central court (H) was paved all around its edges and that a colonnade also existed along its four sides (FIG. 18 *a*). Discussion above of the dated deposits indicates that the construction date for these features should be early in the Neopalatial period possibly soon after the MM III A destruction in early MM III B, while the last phase of use was early in the LM I A period, for abandonment and dismantling preceded the fall of Theran ash at the end of the LM I A period. Limited evidence from a small test raises the possibility that there had been a MM II predecessor.

ROOM M

The adjacent room to the north of court H is thus delimited on its south side by a wall fragment and a plaster edge continuing the lost line of this wall. Like the court it had two superimposed floors (with perhaps a third intermediate one). The first was a well-laid plastered surface, the others were very much eroded and comprised little more than patchy clay relayings some 5 cm thick, silted over and containing scattered blue pebbles. These floors petered out at an irregular erosion line c.2.0 m to the north, but significantly the deep and characteristic levelling fill for the floor continued further and ended in a straight line at Compartment N, part of the deeply founded North Terrace wall (discussed above) which delimits this sector of the building on its north side (PLATE 42 *c*). This wall is nowhere preserved up to the level of the plastered floor of Room M, and it links with a very deep-set (?robbed-out) wall at the west side, but the large boulder-like stones at its east end survive close to floor level. It must once have stood much higher, and been an integral part of this building complex.

At first sight the plastered space designated Room M seems to have been a large room comparable in size to the court at its south, but a northward turn in the plaster ridge marking the south wall line and a line of rough bedding also turning north at right angles implies that there was a partition wall inside this space towards the east.⁶³ There is too little evidence to warrant further discussion here, though further excavation might reveal information on the plan and function of the space in preceding periods.⁶⁴ The sparse sherd scatter over the floor and the extensive deposits spreading down over the eroded top and the north face of the North Terrace Wall, but originating from this area, indicate a period of use including MM III B and early LM I A.

ROOM N

The small rectangular compartment near the north-east corner of this wing of the building was constructed as part of the North Terrace Wall and attached to its inner face. Its east wall

⁶¹ The construction is of small stones (H. 5–10 cm; W. c.30 cm), suitable for a mud-brick superstructure. One line runs north–south, parallel to the west wall of the court, and shows a semi-circular gap which could have held a column base of diameter c.25 cm.

⁶² For an account of the steps, and their latest use (MM III A), see discussion of Room L below.

⁶³ The line appears as a one-course reconstruction of the footings on the air photo at PLATE 39.

⁶⁴ Excavation at the associated space adjacent to the West Façade has begun to show a sequence of MM III to LM I A deposits of some quality here, including fresco fragments.

was well constructed (0.60 m thick, preserved c.1.0 m high) but its south wall, running along the contour, was poorly preserved and contained collapsed schist slabs which suggested that it may have served as a support for a staircase. Both the strong outer wall and the interior lines were severely damaged and included large stones pushed out of line, possibly by seismic action.

ROOMS F, P, Q

The first room accessible from the colonnade is Room F, a space much damaged and eroded. It was entered at the north-west where the opening is 1.35 m wide, but if we restore two Γ -shaped doorbases 0.24 m wide (as suggested by some rubble bedding at the south side) we have a door 0.85 m wide which would appear from the outside to continue the line of the adjacent polythyron door system. The floor was of pinkish plaster, now preserved only along the west and north edges. Its level is close to that of the early sandstone line of Main Street revealed in our test, but some 50 cm below the present street surface. In the eroded adjacent Rooms P and Q further traces of plaster flooring survived. The hypothesis that this space connected to some kind of entrance to Main Street at the very corner of the building could only be tested by dismantling the strongly built later façade, which was partly constructed on top of the floor.

Part of Q and the adjacent space to the north was excavated in 1991 as ES 90, and revealed a paved drain of MM II date (*PK* 1991, 125–6), a predecessor to that at Room J and of similar form: another glimpse of the structure of an earlier Building 6.

ROOM A, THE MINOAN HALL (PLAN AT FIG. 3)

The second and main room accessible from the colonnade is Room A, entered through a polythyron, which, because of the presence of a colonnade gives the appearance of a Minoan Hall, an architectural system of axially situated rooms consisting of hall, vestibule (here formed by the colonnade) and lightwell (here suggested by Court H). It is the first of its kind at Palaikastro. The adjacent town blocks were provided with a different system comprising a four-columned hall with rectangular *impluvium* in the centre. A reconstruction of the two contrasting systems is shown at FIG. 18.

The colonnade with vestibule, 2.60 m wide, is described above. The pier and door partition consists of five door-jamb bases, two of Γ -shape at either end and three of T-shape in the middle. Two very unusual features of these bases are first their material, namely a hard green stone, serpentine or serpentinite, and second the fact that the three T-shaped jambs consist of two separate pieces each: a single rectangular block and a block cut specially to receive the doors. However only the central T-shaped block and the western Γ -shaped block were well preserved (PLATE 43 *d*), the rest being quite damaged (PLATE 45 *a–c*). Because of their fragility and poor state of preservation it was decided to remove them and replace them with cement copies (with green colouring, PLATE 45 *d*). This operation made further interesting observations possible: an earlier wall was found to exist beneath the bases, but on a slightly different alignment so not simply a foundation course. In fact the bases were partly founded on earth, increasingly so to the west, and this no doubt explains why they were found subsided from their original horizontal position. This could be earthquake related, but not because of the strength of the tremors, but rather because they were founded on loose earth and shifted until they found the firmer level of the earlier wall beneath, upon which they settled. The bases, catalogued as **A** to **E** from the west, have individual characteristics, partly due to variations in their states of preservation:

A. (PLATE 45 *a*) A single piece, $44 \times 24 \times 19$ –22 (c.15 only showing); projection 7 wide on NE side with additional knob 13 cm down, 6 high, and 4 wide; ridge on east side 9 down, 5 wide. Pink plaster on the north and east sides connected the base with the surrounding paving.

B. Two pieces with red plaster between, south and north. South: rectangular, $33 \times 19 \times 12$; north: very weathered at top, better preserved at bottom; W. 46, H. c.21; Th., varied, much larger at east where it almost touched the rectangular piece. Projections weathered, except for slight trace at west.

C. (PLATES 44 *d*, 45 *b–c*) Two pieces. North with the two cuttings W. 46, H. c.22.; L.10 only. South: similar to **B** (south)

D. Two pieces. North: poorly preserved, and set partly beneath the adjacent sideropetra slab, either because this shifted, or it was set in position later. Faint traces of projections survived on either side. South: rectangular, $32 \times 18 \times 13$.

E. A single piece, poorly preserved and badly broken; W c.29, H.18; trace of lateral cutting and knob; basically the mirror image of **A**. Red plaster on the east side.

The line of piers and doors is set slightly in front (north) of the lateral walls. The doorways measure 0.80–0.90 in width, and lead to a paved room 4.85 wide by c.4.45 m deep. The paving is made up of purple schist slabs (and a single green one) with traces of plaster in the interstices, no doubt originally painted red like the wall plaster, of which traces remain. The slabs had been disturbed at the south where an earlier excavation trench followed the line of the South Façade, leaving only chips of the original paving. In addition a shallow robbing-pit of LM III B date had removed some of the paving towards the north-west corner of the room. The walls are poorly preserved. The east wall, standing only c.0.15–0.20 m high, is of rubble and schist construction c.0.35 m in width. Much of its central section is lost, but traces of plaster still adhere to each of its faces. The South Façade at Main Street (discussed above) is represented at street level by a later rebuild of sideropetra slabs, but an underlying course projecting out some 0.17 m should belong with the construction phase of this hall (as with that of Room F). The west wall (W. 0.60 m) is hardly preserved above the floor level of the hall but red plaster is preserved on its east face, and much more of its structure was revealed by tests in the adjacent Room B (discussed below).

ROOM B

This room, adjacent to Hall A, measures c.2.10 $\times$ 4.45 m and could be entered from Court H, at least in a late phase, through a small stepped doorway or break in the wall at the north. At the top of the fill a collapse of building debris comprises broken and fallen slabs (one measuring $30 \times 22 \times 6$) which appear to derive from the steps at the north side. Included was part of a sandstone horns of consecration, similar to others found in Well 576 (discussed above). This debris and a large spread (c.0.65 $\times$ 0.60 $\times$ 0.10 m) of light grey ash, probably Theran, suggest abandonment before mature LM I A. Similar ash was noted in other parts of the building, indicated by stars in FIG. 2, and seems to be part of a wider pattern (discussed below).

A final period of use is shown by two makeshift cooking areas formed by a circle of stones on an earth floor at 11.10[^] (early LM I A?). But the principal floors are a yellow clay surface at 10.46[^] (MM III A) and a reddish earth surface at 10.77[^] with thin build-up of grey occupation debris (MM III B), and the only associated feature was a large boulder-like base (c.40 $\times$ 30; H.18 cm) on the latter. At the lowest level in the south-west corner of the room a bridge-spouted jar was found upside down set into the rock at 10.25–10.30[^] as a foundation deposit.

The west wall had been supported by a wooden framework with three vertical beams, the decay of which caused serious collapse. The east wall, which can be seen in elevation in the deep sounding at the south side of the room, stands c.80–100 cm high, was constructed of

good medium-sized stones and was founded deeper, on a ledge specially cut in the bedrock to receive it, as was the South Façade, into whose lower courses the east wall was bonded. In type of construction this wall resembles the north wall of Rooms B and C, and it may be contemporary with the east walls of Rooms D2 and D1.

ROOM C

This narrow compartment, only *c.*0.70 m wide, has the appearance of a staircase, an interpretation supported by the occurrence at the top of the fill of slabs suitable for stair treads: one measures $38 \times 15 \times 9$ cm, another, specially dressed with corner cutting and with plaster adhering, measures 29×32 , but with the cut side only 21 (and the cutting 15 cm deep). A staircase here may have been the source of similar debris in Room B. The east wall (W. 0.53 m) has a flat surface, probably built as a socle for mud-brick, and there may have been access from Room B at its north end, where a good sideropetra block ($38 \times 14 \times 9$) is set flat on the top of the wall. This block, however, is set at a very high level and an associated staircase would not relate to the MM III floors below. An examination of the wall's fabric shows that it was built of small stones founded on a slightly wider socle, and is preserved *c.*70 cm high. It shows evidence for xylodesia (paired vertical beams perhaps connected through the wall's thickness), and used vertical beams *c.*10 cm wide. The wall is a late addition, put in perhaps towards the end of the MM III B period, to subdivide an originally larger space into Rooms B and C as we have them. There is no evidence for access from any of the other sides at this period.⁶⁵

The west wall stands 80 cm high and is constructed of medium-sized stones similar to those of the east and north walls of Room B. The north wall, a continuous line with that of Room B, goes deeper, is preserved *c.*105 cm high in six courses, and had a foundation deposit (a jar placed upside down) against it at depth 10.22[^]. A small deposit of conical cups was found in the west part of the room (remnants of an under-stair cupboard?).

ROOM D1

This room is only partially excavated, but the lowest floor reached is at 10.52[^], belonging perhaps early in the MM III period. On it lay a good ashlar slab and a deposit of conical cups, stacked as if fallen from a cupboard. Its north wall, preserved 55 cm high, seems to be contemporary with the earliest part of the West Façade. The fill, both water-borne silt over the floor and a later wash with scattered debris, points to episodes of flooding, sometimes severe.

The surface wall over Room D1, running obliquely from northeast to southwest with a return east at its south end, is based higher than any other in the area: the top course of the return east rises to 11.53[^], and the northern blocks to 11.88[^], compared with the highest surviving top of any MM III or LM I A wall at 11.30–11.45[^]. Only the adjacent surface wall outside the West Façade, perhaps to be connected with a late entrance to the area from Main Street⁶⁶ and with Well 576 (LM I B) is as high. The oblique wall is one course high and 65–70 cm wide at the south end (where it seems to link with the South Façade), but at the north end it is built up with large stones to form a more massive platform *c.*85 $\times$ 70 cm, reminiscent of the LM I B and LM III platforms in the area between Buildings 1 and 4.⁶⁷ The LM II pottery deposit with twin vase discussed above relates to this structure.

⁶⁵ For a possible blocked door, once entering from the west, see under Room D2 below.

⁶⁶ Shown on the 1904 plan of the site, as an entrance to

Block M (*PKU*, pl. 1).

⁶⁷ e.g. at EQ 93 (on plan at *PK* 1987, 260 and fig. 1).

ROOM D2

The west wall of Room D2 has six irregular courses of small and medium-sized stones. The east wall may perhaps be a rebuild of an earlier wall with doorway: about halfway up, a level of flat stones can be interpreted as the top of a foundation for a mud-brick wall, with traces of a doorway in the centre. The door, originally giving access to the space B/C, would have been blocked and the whole wall built higher afterwards. The north wall consists of six irregular courses of small stones (60 cm high) on 7 cm of earth over the lowest floor (at 10.36[^]), from which the line of an earlier wall protrudes.

This earlier wall (one course of medium-sized stones, *c.*10–15 cm high) runs beneath part of the east wall and beneath the west and north walls. It projects *c.*10–15 cm out from the later (MM III B?) wall-lines, and with the floor at 10.36[^] perhaps belongs with a MM III A building.

ROOM E1

Room E1 is a small room, 2.0 m (E–W) by 1.65 m (N–S), accessible in its later phases only by three steps descending from a higher level at the south. The north and east walls, preserved up to 1.20 m high, show three phases: a MM III B rebuild on an earlier construction (MM II B to MM III A) with a later capping (LM I A?). The west wall, whose fabric is of small stones in five irregular courses, is a later (2nd phase) construction built over an earlier wall, the MM III A partition line with Room D1, which shows a break halfway along, perhaps an earlier entrance.

With these construction phases go three earth floor levels. The earliest, a clay floor at 10.40[^], is associated with the first phase and showed evidence of burning. A test through this floor in the north-east corner of the room showed that the make-up of the floor was a fine yellow clay packing *c.*15 cm thick, set close above red virgin soil and that the wall foundations extended *c.*20 cm below the floor surface to be based on bedrock, thus giving very comparable results to the tests in H and at the north entrance, and suggesting uniform and contemporary construction. The fine polychrome Knossian cup fragment found above this floor and its chronology are discussed above (cf. FIG. 15). Fragments of fine red and white marbled plaster also from the associated fill attest to a room whose finish was of high quality in its early phase.

The southern stepped entrance seems not to belong with this but with the succeeding phase, since the third and lowest step stops at a higher clay floor which, at 10.55[^], is to be associated with the second phase walls (MM III B). The steps (W. 85, H. *c.*20, depth 20–5 cm) are of stones and clay and were probably originally surfaced with a red plaster, angular fragments of which were found in the fill. A pile of masonry found at the south side of the room seems to represent upper floor fall; it included a door-jamb base in green serpentine which had fallen upside down and is so similar to those found in Room A that it must have been made in the same workshop, and should be from the same construction phase.⁶⁸ Significant in that it provides evidence for finely appointed upper rooms over what may be a range of basements (all we now find preserved), it is also an important, perhaps conclusive, indicator of the chronology of the main polythyron (at Room A) and the associated colonnade (H). Since the collapse belongs in a MM III B context, the construction date must be

⁶⁸ It is finely cut on all sides but left rough beneath. It measures 45 × 27 × 16 cm and has a Γ-shape with

projection 4 cm deep and 10 cm wide. For parallel shape cf. PLATE 45 *a*.

contemporary or earlier. Thus the association of LM I A sherds with these latter features should be interpreted as illustrating only the latest phase of use, perhaps a post-destruction phase.

The function of the sunken Room E1 is not entirely clear. It seems too small to have been a canonical lustral basin and too far away from Hall A. But this interpretation remains possible, considering that the lustral basin in Block B⁶⁹ is comparable in size, and that painted plaster in E1 does give evidence of decoration both in MM III B period, and in the preceding phase.⁷⁰

ROOM E2

Room E2 is a small compartment (c.1.50 m N-S × 0.83 m E-W), entered from the passageway at Room L2. Its eastern wall, at the north end, has three slots for wooden uprights quite close together. It may have served as a cupboard, or a light-well for Room E1.

ROOM L

Room L produced the fullest and most instructive sequence of stratified deposits, and these can be linked with major structural changes. In the first phase (MM III A) there were two rooms, a large, paved area at L1 and 3 with a corridor at the south (L2); in the second phase (MM III B) it was subdivided into three spaces, a sizeable room at L3 with an L-shaped corridor (L1 and L2) around it; and in the third phase (MM III B/LM I A) it was a large single room.

In considering the function of the room⁷¹ it should be noted that a surprising amount of painted plaster was found throughout all levels. Although the fragments are not yet cleaned or studied, it is clear that some of the fragments associated with the early phase show imitation veined marble, similar to that found in the local quarry south of Vai, itself very much like the quarry at Kionia, west of Siteia.⁷² Similar plaster has been found in the Lustral Basin of the Queen's Megaron at Knossos and the Splantzia Lustral Basin at Khania.⁷³ Since fragments with this decoration were found in Room E1 as well as L2, their original position is open to question, but Room L does have a sunken basin in its north-west corner, a feature which could be compared in a general way with the sunken chamber of Room E1 described above. The connection of the imitation marble with lustral basins strengthens the hypothesis that one of these rooms is an early Palaikastro parallel for the 'lustral basin'.

Variations in the fabric of the walls are also illustrative of three construction phases in Room L. The east wall is preserved more than 1.0 m high, but at c.35 cm above the Phase 1 floor the elevation shows the line of a rebuild, corresponding to the level of the second period floor paving. Preserved up to c.90 cm above the early floor, this rebuild was cut through for a later (MM III B/LM I A) doorway with slabs. At this time also a new top course of smaller stones contrasting with the MM fabric of good medium-sized stones below was added, perhaps for a mud-brick superstructure. The north wall of Room L, where visible, seems to

⁶⁹ PK I, pl. xx; PK VII, 207.

⁷⁰ Although no access steps have yet been revealed for this period, it remains possible that there had been an earlier stepped entrance, perhaps at the gap visible in the lower courses of the south wall, as there was in Room L, described below. Later structural alterations at the south side of the room are shown by a short stretch of wall immediately to the west of the

steps, directly above a possible first period entrance. For further discussion of the painted plaster, see under Room L below.

⁷¹ See discussion above, relating to possible murex dye working in MM III A, cf. also n. 26.

⁷² Cf. M. K. Durkin and C. J. Lister, 'The Rods of Digenis', *BSA* 78 (1983), 69.

⁷³ Cf. n. 28.

show a similar pattern: a late rebuild (bonded into the east wall's top course) runs above a MM III B line (visible only on the north face of the wall) which is built on a MM III A line.

The south wall of Room L (L2) is more complicated. Of greater thickness (W.1.0 m), it also shows at least two phases, separated by an earth-filled gap, where a horizontal wooden beam (L.1.40 m; 20 × 20 cm in section) would have disintegrated. This beam-slot lies immediately below the top course (LM I A),⁷⁴ but seems to have connected with three uprights at the western end of this wall, and perhaps with another on the south face, at the west of Room E1. The extra wall thickness and the strong timber frame (not easily identified elsewhere) perhaps indicate the need to support a special structure on the upper floor here.

The earliest architectural phase is also the finest: a large room (c.3.20 m × 4.50 m) entirely paved with fine large purple schist slabs having good lustrous white plaster in the interstices. Similar plaster runs continuously a short way up all four walls, showing that they belong to the same architectural layout. The room was accessible from the south by a small plastered staircase of which two steps survive, but are poorly preserved. The bottom step is 1.0 m in width, c.0.24 m deep and 0.20 m high; the second step at least 0.85 m wide, 0.40 m deep and 0.14 m high, rising to 10.60' from floor level at c.10.25'. The steps are constructed of stones with ample filling of clay and have a plaster coat more than 1 cm thick; two coats can be seen where the plaster turns up to the second step and becomes less well preserved. Beside the bottom step two slots side by side in the plaster may have held a round post (D.10 cm) and a rectangular post (18 × 9 cm), perhaps part of a structural support or handrail. The bottom step was constructed up against the south wall dividing L3 from L2; the upper one was built over by the Cape Sidero slabs of a later stairway, and it could not be traced further without removing these, although there was a burnt destruction deposit 30 cm deep with vase in the intervening space. It remains uncertain whether these steps led to an upper storey, or ended at the present level (10.60') which is the same as that of the clay and plaster predecessor to the Court (H) (as shown in the small test in its south-west corner).

In the north-west corner of the room is an unusual shallow basin measuring c.1.25 × 2.60 m. It has paving of purple schist slabs⁷⁵ with white plastered interstices and has finely moulded corners and plastered edges which vary in depth from 6 to 20 cm. At its south-west corner is a plastered inlet or runnel (W. 25 cm), and there may have been another at the northeast. At the north-west, where plaster survives as much as 17 cm high, three small red stains (dye?) were observed on the plaster surface of the runnel, as well as two parallel painted bands (W. 1 cm), dark green or blue in colour, running like a border parallel to the wall line.

In the second period (MM III B) the room was subdivided by an oblique wall (H. 0.60; W. 0.35 m) made of small and medium-sized fieldstones and capped with schist slabs. The lower courses of the existing south wall dividing L2 from L3 were reused and incorporated into the new line, which now partly rested on the upper mudbrick step. A foundation deposit (shallow bowl) was placed in the fabric of the new construction at the corner. To accommodate this new structure the basin was filled in with packing material, which with a rubble and earth levelling for a second, partly paved floor, produced the earliest stratified material from the room, including fallen plaster and pottery. A possible reason for the construction of this wall is

⁷⁴ This would place it inconveniently close to the floor level at this period, but it was evidently part of an earlier framework.

⁷⁵ These are slightly smaller than those used for the floor of the room (e.g. 23 × 50 cm as against 50 × 50 or 90 × 55 cm).

to retain an already unmanageable mass of debris fallen from the West Façade in one of a series of destructions, perhaps seismic. The area of L1 was left choked with a stone fill, while the fill of L2 contained a pot deposit (tripod cooking pot, cups, bowls) in a sandy matrix up to c.10.40[^]. In L3 a second floor was laid down and partly paved, some 25–30 cm above the original one (at c.10.50[^]), and on this a silt layer (suggesting flooding) was overlaid by a burnt destruction deposit (c.50 cm thick), with fallen plaster, charred organic material, stone tumble and burnt mudbrick—indicating a major destruction of the building involving fire.

Above this another paved floor was laid (at c.10.90[^]), incorporating the surviving top courses of the dividing wall in its surface. Poorly preserved over most of its area and covered with fragmentary schist slabs, many probably fallen from an upper floor, this surface links up with the fine sideropetra slabs of a stepped entrance from the court H at the south-east corner of the room, where the floor was best preserved. This was evidently an LM I A breach through the original wall line, which continues beneath the paving slabs,⁷⁶ a scenario similar to that found at the entrance to Room B described above. In this last phase, then, Room L could be reached via three steps: one slab formed the top step, two formed the second and the doorway proper and three slabs formed the bottom step within the room itself. All these slabs are between 6 and 10 cm thick; the lower ones are c.65 cm long, the two preserved higher up are c.85 cm long. Over this floor at c.11.16[^] was found a compact greyish brown sandy layer with pithos fragments and other finds, perhaps representing the final occupation phase which was followed by unburnt destruction, collapse, and abandonment. Among the overlying debris, some 20 to 25 cm thick, was roofing material including a fragment of square section drainpipe in terracotta, perhaps from a rooftop drain,⁷⁷ and a finely cut but fragmentary column base fallen from the upper floor.⁷⁸ It is worth adding that in 1991 a part of the same deposit with fallen pots was found in the area of Rooms E and L in EP/EQ 84 and EP83, when sections of the wall tops were first revealed,⁷⁹ and that the fine fallen fresco fragments with floral motif⁸⁰ come from the area immediately outside the west wall of Room I and could have fallen from its upper room.

ROOM J (THE AREA OF THE EASTERN DRAIN; PLATE 42 *a–b*)

Returning to the propylon and going east we first come to a complicated area with a series of parallel walls perhaps best explained as LM I A rebuilds of earlier MM structures (as in Room F). There are four parallel walls close together, two at the sides of the drain and two others flanking the drain walls. Traces of rebuilding are clear at the west end of these walls and indicate that the two outer walls were in place first, and that the drain was later built in the space between. Then the west end of the existing walls had to be raised and the gaps were filled with rubble. In addition the outer wall on the south side was built up higher, in order to provide a good side wall for the propylon.

⁷⁶ The slab which originally formed the threshold and top step had slipped down inside the room and was found on top of three lower slabs. A test at this point in the entrance revealed a packing fill similar to that noted in the test at the SW corner of the colonnade in court H. Below this the original line of the east wall of Room L continued.

⁷⁷ An area of light grey ashy material, c.1.0 × 1.0 m and 0.10 deep covered the centre of the room. Roofing domatochoma or volcanic ash? Analysis pending.

⁷⁸ The column base is of green serpentine (original D c.32

cm and H.6.9 cm; actual fragment 16.1 × 14.6 × 6.9 cm). The top has a border 2.9 cm wide which is raised 2 mm above the centre (to prevent the wooden column from slipping). The flat base shows the remains of a drill-hole (D.2 cm), probably for a wooden peg more than 2 cm long which held the column base in position on a wooden surface. (It cannot be excluded, however, that this fragment is part of a pyramidal stand, similar to an example from the Psychro Cave.)

⁷⁹ Refs. at n. 55.

⁸⁰ PK 91, 128 and fig. 6.

The drain itself is well constructed with fine close-fitting schist paving-slabs and is *c.*0.40 m wide. Its depth is only *c.*0.20 m at the west, but increases to 0.47 m as it descends to the east. It served the court with which it is linked by a large red schist slab ($0.77 \times 0.45 \times 0.05$) on which the side walls are based, leaving a well-constructed access *c.*0.35 m wide. The drain must have originally been covered, probably by schist slabs, since there is a line of disintegrated schist chips in place in the east section directly above the drain.

Room J is quite narrow (only 1.35 m wide) and it may have served as a support for a staircase giving access to a balcony above the colonnade which ran round the court. All over this area a mass of small chips of pinkish limestone was found which appear to derive from fallen paving. These could well have formed the flooring of such a balcony.

No floor level was found in the area of Room J, but most of the hollow area to the east was covered by a layer of light-grey volcanic ash, some 12 cm thick, which we may associate with the tephra from the Minoan eruption of Thera.⁸¹ The sequence shown on the section at FIG. 16 indicates that this found its way here *after* the destruction and dismantling of the LM I A building, for the drain covers had already been robbed out and the drain silted up.

ROOM K, A PLASTERED COMPARTMENT, AND THE AREA TO ITS NORTH

The next area to the north we may call Room K, although it is not yet clear whether this is a room, a corridor, or some other (industrial?) installation. Its main feature is a fine white plaster floor as well as the white stucco against the lower part of the north wall, *c.*1 cm thick and slightly polished.

The north wall of Room K (W. 0.54, H. pres. 0.30–35 m at the west but thickening to W. 0.75 with H. 0.50 at the east) links at its east end with a strongly built return wall turning to the north and presumably joining the street wall shown on the 1904 plan, and thus forming the limit to Building 6 on the east side. This return wall is of sideropetra rubble (W. *c.*0.80, H. *c.*0.80) and appears to have two phases, the higher build of the outer face perhaps continuing in use after the LM I A period. The thicker eastern stretch of Room K north wall should have a similar history, but at its lower west end this wall (now below LM I A floor level) must have included a LM I A rebuild on an earlier (MM) foundation. The general dismantling of Building 6 during LM I A, involving robbing walls out to their foundation, explains the abrupt end of the plaster floor of this area at the west where the connection with the plastered room M and the colonnaded court H are not clear.

Little can yet be said about the large square space to the north of Room K. Immediately north of K in Trench ES 83 a 1904 test, apparently 0.80 m wide and following an eroded wall line here, was refilled with rubble. In the adjacent trench ES 84 the early foundations of major wall lines were found with fill and packing, but were preserved only below LM I A floor level.

BUILDING 6, CONCLUSIONS

It should be assumed that the major entrance to the Southeast Building was at the south, giving access to the propylon, and thence to the court and the paved Hall. If a staircase to the balcony was situated in Room J (over the drain), then a main entrance would at the same time have given access to the propylon and the staircase. Taking the western wall of Rooms D–M as the West Façade, we can estimate the dimensions of this building as *c.*25 m E–W by 20 m N–S,

⁸¹ Analysis by Chris Doherty of the Archaeological Research Laboratory, Oxford.

a size comparable with the domestic units excavated in previous campaigns. However, this building seems to have been quite different from other structures in the town of Roussolakkos: its central position, its regularity (with most rooms situated round a central court), its architectural features (propylon, paving, pier and door partition, colonnade) and decoration (schist, frescoes and horns of consecration) combine to distinguish this from other buildings along Main Street. This first appearance of a Minoan Hall at Palaikastro coincides with its introduction at Knossos and elsewhere early in the Neopalatial Period. The contrast of this architectural layout with the now familiar Palaikastro hall (four columns around a shallow basin) could be attributable to a strong Knossian influence at this time or the halls themselves belong to a later period. The total abandonment and disappearance of the building in LM I A and its outspoken Knossian features are noteworthy.

What was the construction date of this important building? The four different foundation deposits suggest that the entire building as we excavated it was built by the MM III A period. There seem to be four main phases:

(i) a large MM III A construction (preceded by a substantial MM II building, known from several tests)⁸² with fine paved and plastered areas; some evidence for destruction in Room L, probably by earthquake;

(ii) a rebuild shortly afterwards in the MM III B period along similar lines. Probably to this phase belongs the fine external veneer built to impress: slab floors, pier-and-doors, frescoes and columns, i.e. true Knossian influence; building destroyed by earthquake closely following an episode of flooding;

(iii) partial reconstruction of the building at a higher level. Again more or less the same lines were followed. A final destruction, perhaps seismic, took place during LM I A. Much of the building was dismantled, before the tephra fell, at the end of LM I A,

(iv) a late phase (LM I B–LM III). The whole area was given a surrounding wall with a good façade to the south. Perhaps not a monumental court (as at Kommos); the only internal features are now two wells and probably pasture.⁸³

The circulation pattern of the original building remains problematical, partly due to the obscuring effect of the late rebuilding. Communication from the court (H) to Rooms A and F is clear, as is that of E1/D2 and E2/L2. Clear evidence for a main entrance, from G, is lacking, although the complex does seem to be organized in that direction; and it is surprising that we have found no entrance in the South Façade.

The most striking characteristic of the building is its use of colour: in the first phase a purple schist floor outlined in white plaster and imitation marble as well as other fresco remains; in the main phase fresco and contrasting colour in the paving, yellow-pink porch slabs, deep grey-green column bases, grey-blue sideropetra slabs of the portico, purple schist slabs again with plaster surround in Room A, and the green serpentine door-jamb bases leading to Room A and fallen from above into Room E1. Surprising is the sheer number of architectural items in serpentine: five door-jamb bases (at A), another from E1, a fragmentary column base from L and a fragmentary door-jamb from a dry-stone wall just west of D1 and hence probably originating from this building. Except for a single large door-jamb base in the

⁸² These tests were at the north terrace wall, in the southwest corner of the central court (H) and the deep drain at R1, and reveal a building of good quality with fine plastered floors. Little evidence for destruction, perhaps just abandonment.

⁸³ For the protection of livestock and water sources after the Santorini eruption cf. J. Driessen and C. F. MacDonald, *The Troubled Island: The Santorini Eruption and the LM I B Destruction of Minoan Crete* (Aegaeum 17, 1997).

North Entrance of the Palace of Malia, serpentine seems not to have been used as an architectural medium, apart from occasional column bases, and then again with the aim to provide polychromy. In the final period, these features may have continued in use, and there is evidence for fine floral fresco work.

Finally horns of consecration were found in and near the building: a large fragment in fine-grained purple sandstone comes from beside the North Terrace Wall, and other fragments in sandstone were found, one in the upper fill of Room B and at least three others, plastered but with traces of red colouring, in the fill of the adjacent Well 576 (description below), so very possibly deriving from this building.

THE HORNS OF CONSECRATION FROM WELL 576 AND ROOM B BY J. M. DRIESSEN

From the LM II–III A₁ fill of Well 576 come four fragments of at least three different stone horns of consecration, all three originally more or less identical. They are carefully made in soft sandstone (ammoudha) and plastered over (with white plaster, but there are also some tiny traces of red). FIG. 19 shows these four fragments.

Catalogue

Dimensions are in centimetres.

No. 0843, SF 41 (four pieces) from Well 576:

1. 41a. Left horn (top broken off) and part of body; ammoudha, plastered over. H.(body) 11; L. (pres.) 19; H.(max.pres.) 23.5; W.(body) 10.5, (horn) 8.
2. 41b. Left horn (top broken off) and start of body; ammoudha, plastered over. H.(body) 11; L. (pres.) 20; H.(horn, max.pres.) 21.5; W.(body) 8, (horn) 8 decreasing to 7.
3. 41c. Central part of body; ammoudha, plastered

over. H.(body) 10; L.(pres.) 14; W.(body) 9. Flat base.

4. 41d. Body and start and base of right horn; ammoudha, plastered over. H.(body) 10; L.(pres.) 22; H.(start of horn) 18; W.(body) 9, (start of horn) 8. Flat base. From Building 6 Room B:

5. 102 (EP 82). Complete left horn but without base; start of body. H.(max.pres.) 16; L. (max.pres.) 12; W.(horn) 9 decreasing to 4 at top.

It is possible that fragments 41b and 41c originally formed part of a single pair.

These are the largest stone horns so far found at Roussolakkos: during the old excavations some large stucco horns (W. 27 cm) were found in Block B⁸⁴ and elsewhere in the town were found three or four stone horns of consecration, one of which appears quite similar to those discussed here.⁸⁵ During the survey campaign in 1983, two joining pieces (W. 25 cm) were found in the area of Building 1 (*PK Survey*, 136, plate 11 a) from which another fragment was recovered during the 1987 excavations (*PK* 1987, 265). A recent study of such horns stresses their distribution throughout the island and their contextual association with important places of cult or power.⁸⁶ Part of a horn (no. 5 here) in unplastered sandstone was also found in Room B of Building 6 (EP 82, SF 102) and it is tempting to believe that all horns originally derive from this building. In the well they appear to form part of the LM II–III A₁ fill. It seems likely that Building 6 suffered from an earthquake destruction in LM I A after which

⁸⁴ *PK* I, 314, fig. 27.

⁸⁵ *PK* II, 280, fig. 2.

⁸⁶ A. L. D'Agata, 'Late Minoan Crete and horns of

consecration: a symbol in action', in R. Laffineur and J. L. Crowley (eds), *EIKΩN: Aegean Bronze Age Iconography* (Aegaeum 8; Liège, 1992), 247–55.

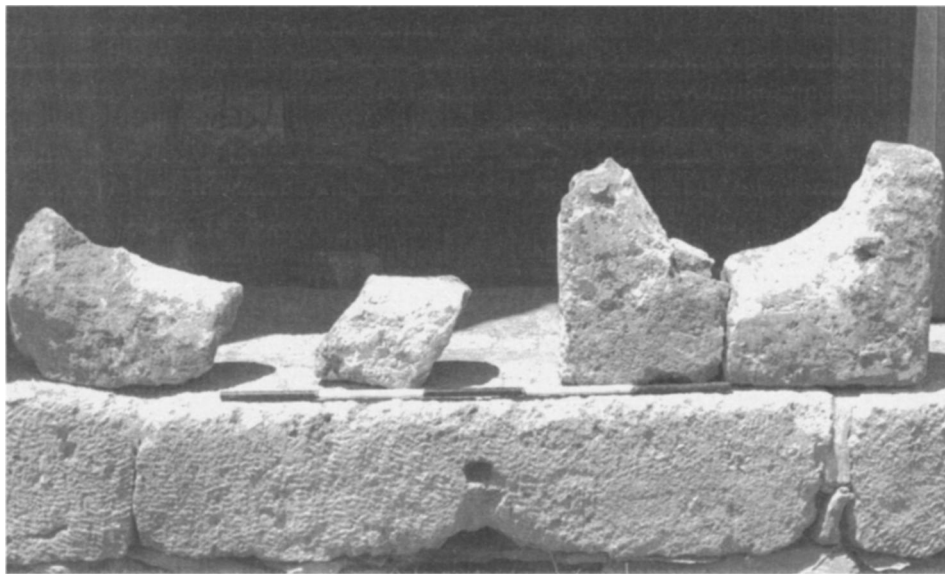


FIG. 19 Fragments of stone horns of consecration from Well 576; L to R nos. 41 d, c, b, a.

dismantling activities started before the tephra was deposited. Did further clearance take place in LM II–III A or does the concentration of horn fragments suggest that they come from some other building partly destroyed in LM I B which had to be made ready for reoccupation (e.g. Building 1 or 5)?

A TEST ACROSS MAIN STREET (δ – μ) BY ELENI HATZAKI

A small sounding was made across Main Street to test the phasing of the paved street surfaces and their relation with Block Delta to the south and Building 6 (B6) to the North. The primary goals were to date the installation of the sandstone paving and drain which form the present surface of Main Street, and to identify possible earlier street levels. The test was successful and yielded significant new stratigraphical evidence relevant to the main urban phases of the Roussolakkos settlement. A schematic section is given at FIG. 20.

The sector of Main Street called Delta–Mu was exposed in the 1902 excavation campaign, during which a large portion of Block Delta was explored.⁸⁷ Today, much of the street is paved with thin rectangular sandstone slabs, which in the Delta–Mu sector of the street run up to the South Façade of B6. In places where the sandstone paving was robbed or perhaps never positioned, the street surface consists of earth and rubble. The drain which runs along the south side of the street, and which now has an earth floor, is referred to by Bosanquet as ‘the gutter’. Its south face is formed by the North Façade of Block Delta, its north side by purple schist slabs which appear to run under the sandstone paving. Sections of Main Street that are

⁸⁷ For a detailed discussion of the 1902 excavation of Block Delta cf. *PK* II, 292–4.

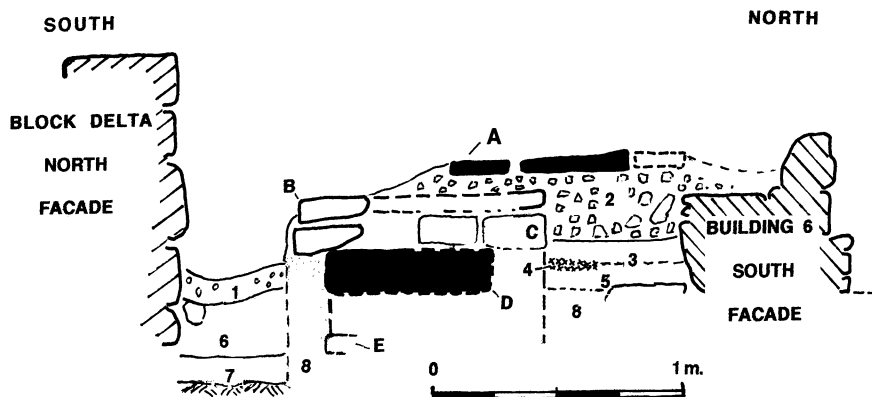


FIG. 20 Schematic section across Main Street.

Key to street paving (A–E) and earth levels (1–8): A. LM II–III Sandstone paving at 11.88⁺; B. LM I B Purple schist paving at 11.64⁺; C. Sandstone blocks, repair to early sandstone paving (LM I); D. MM III–LM I A early sandstone paving at 11.51⁺; E. Earlier MM green schist paving at 11.18⁺. 1. Surface silt in gutter; 2. LM II–III A rubble fill; 3. LM I B silt; 4. Theran ash at 11.35⁺; 5. LM I A silt; 6. Silt in southern gutter; 7. Compact red soil (?natural); 8. Not excavated.

still visible and the 1902–3 Palaikastro plan show that this paving and gutter arrangement stretched for the entire length of Blocks Gamma–Delta and Beta–Mu.⁸⁸

Bosanquet had already distinguished two different pavements in the street. He reported that ‘the fine [sandstone] pavement of Main Street in front of this block [Delta] is secondary: the earlier street was at the level of the bottom of the gutter which is in fact formed of the part of the earlier [purple schist] pavement left uncovered by the construction of the new way’ (PK II, 292).

The 1996 sounding was located in Trenches EQ 81–2 and measured 1.80 m by 1.95 m. The upper stratum consisted of a rubble fill; its removal revealed a 0.55 m section of paving formed by purple schist slabs (0.95 m wide, top at 11.64⁺) and a drain (henceforth Purple Schist Paving and North Drain) which ran between the schist slabs and the South Façade of B6. The pottery collected from the rubble packing dates to LM I B with a few post-LM I B specimens, probably of a LM II or early LM III A date. Removal of the Purple Schist Paving immediately revealed an even earlier paving, this time of well-dressed blocks (0.70 m wide, top at 11.51⁺); henceforth Early Sandstone Paving). The pottery collected from between the two pavings can be dated generally to the Neopalatial period. Excavation within the North Drain revealed a layer of waterborne greyish ash, 2 to 5 cm thick and sandwiched between layers of silt, at 11.35⁺. This has been identified, pending detailed analysis, as Santorini tephra.⁸⁹ The pottery collected from the silty layer below the ash dates to LM I A, whereas the layer above it contained LM I B pottery. Unfortunately the latter layer does not represent a closed deposit, since joins were made with sherds from the higher rubble fill. Excavation within the gutter at the south further revealed traces of an even earlier paving of green schist slabs (Green Schist

⁸⁸ See PK II, pl. 6.

⁸⁹ This was done by visual comparison with previously identified samples proven to be tephra. The identification

was confirmed by Professor F. McCoy, who was present during the excavation.

Paving at 11.18[^]) running under the early Sandstone Paving, which was associated with MM Pottery. This Green Schist Paving is at the same level as the foundation course of the North Façade of Block Delta.

This succession of four phases of paving suggests a great continuity in the street system of the settlement from at least the Old Palace period onwards to the very end of the Bronze Age habitation of the Minoan town. The Neopalatial Early Sandstone Paving is undoubtedly the finest of the different Main Street pavings and matches the exceptional quality of the architecture of both B6 and Block Delta. The silted deposit of Theran ash in the North Drain, stratified above a LM I A level, can be added to the increasing number of ash layers discovered at Roussolakkos. The fact that up to 5 cm of ash was deposited in a functioning drain may imply that quite a considerable ash carpet originally filled the streets. Some time after the ash fall, the Early Sandstone Paving was replaced with an inferior quality paving (Purple Schist Paving), whereas the North Drain continued to be in use. Why this change happened is not clear but it must have been considered necessary, implying that sections of street paving had been damaged from long use or earthquake (for which there is evidence in Area 6). This new set of colourful paving, which according to Bosanquet's descriptions originally ran up to the North Façade of Block Delta, served the LM I B inhabitants of that block but also the enclosed field of Area 6 with Wells 576 and 605. The final phase of modification along Main Street, the laying of the Sandstone Paving, took place soon after the LM I B destructions. Possibly because they too were damaged by the LM I B catastrophe, the North Drain and Purple Schist Paving were completely covered by substantial quantities of rubble and domestic debris. It should be stressed that this rubble fill contained no burnt soil, pottery, or mud-brick and hence was not destruction debris. The early date for the foundation of this sandstone paving, possibly even in LM II, implies that the inhabitants of Palaikastro returned to their ruined town very soon after the LM I B destructions. The raising of the street surface (together with the switching of the drain from the north to the south side of the street) appears as a genuine attempt to provide the town with new public amenities. This activity was obviously given priority amongst what must have been a heavy building schedule. Such an action could well reflect upon the concern of a local authority to provide public facilities within a rebuilt town.⁹⁰ This was the final set of modifications to Main Street, which served the inhabitants of Palaikastro at least until the destruction and subsequent abandonment of their town some time in LM III B.

A NOTE ON THE INSCRIBED MATERIAL OF THE 1994 EXCAVATIONS BY ILSE SCHOEP

Three inscribed objects were found in the course of the 1994 excavations (FIG. 21; PLATE 50): a handle from a medium-sized water jar or oval mouthed amphora in Well 576 showing a single sign (Zb 24), a pithos rim from Bosanquet's backfill in ER 81 with a doodle (Zb 23), and part of a clay disc, a surface find at c.200 m to the east of the excavations (Wy 22). Although only

⁹⁰ Warren has demonstrated that the foundation of a road system at Knossos at MM I B/MM II A provides evidence for a central authority, cf. P.M. Warren, 'The Minoan Roads

of Knossos', in D. Evelyn, H. Hughes-Brock, and N. Momigliano (eds), *Knossos: A Labyrinth of History* (Oxford, 1994), 189–210.

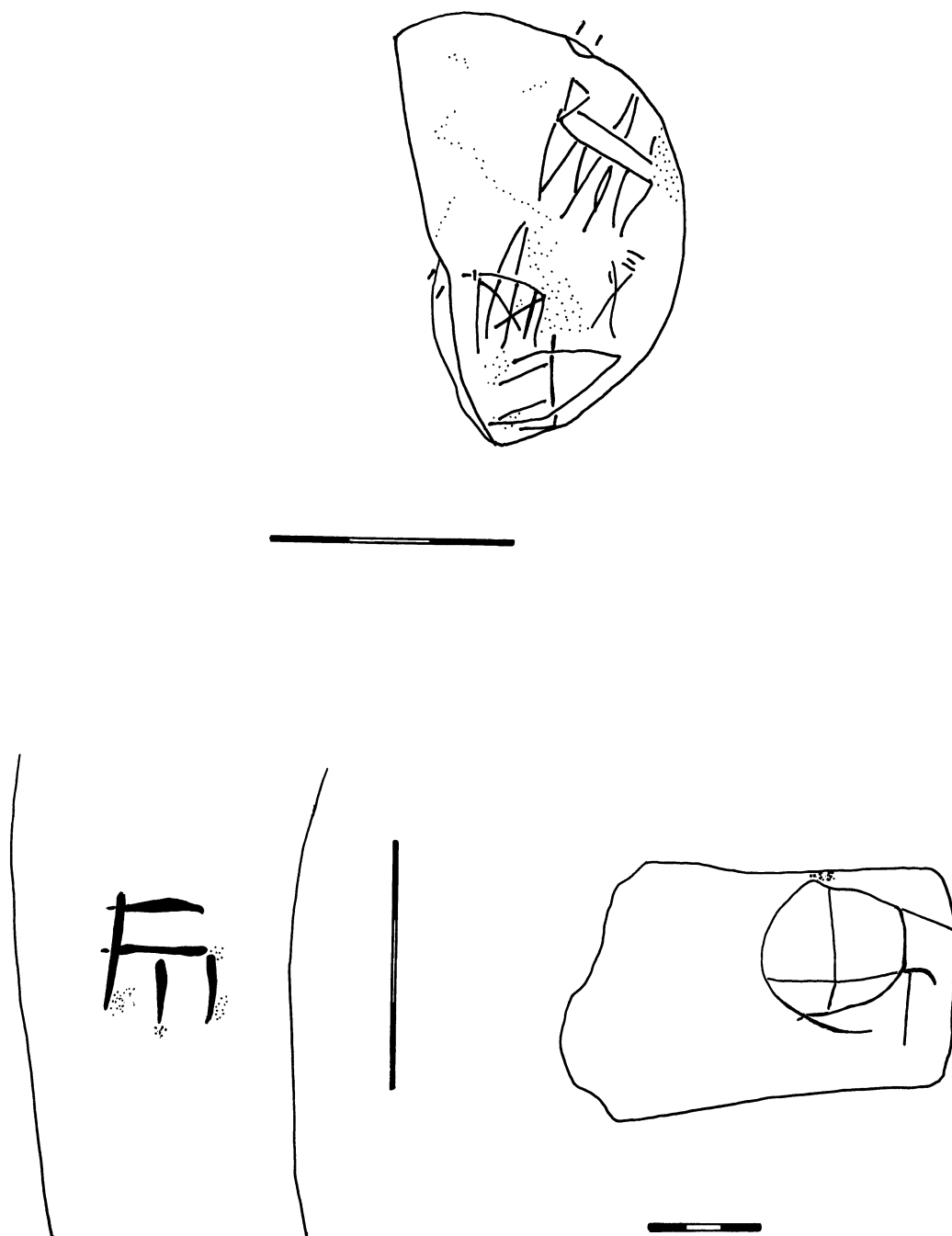


FIG. 21 Inscribed disc and sherds from Palaikastro 1994, (a) Wy22, (b) Zb24 (c) Zb23

the first of these objects was retrieved from an archaeological context (LM II–III A₁ levels), it is especially the latter that deserves attention, although all three help to give a better idea of the literacy of the Bronze Age settlement and may be added to the slowly growing list of documents from the site itself: a single tablet, a painted inscription on a vase and two vase inscriptions.⁹¹

WY 22⁹²

Part of a pierced clay disc was found by Iseut Cronin about 200 m northeast of Block B in an area which apparently does not form part of the centre of the settlement, although remains of roads traced here in the 1983 survey suggest that occupation continued for quite a distance. The disc originally must have had a diameter of 4.8 cm, with now slightly over half surviving (4.40 × 3.10 cm). It is about 1 cm thick in the middle with slightly convex recto and verso. The clay of the disc is finely gritted with some dark and white inclusions. It became fired, probably unintentionally in a conflagration. As a document it may be considered complete, since it was first intentionally cut diagonally and then divided in two more or less equal parts.⁹³ Moreover, the disc was pierced diagonally, which implies that it could hang from something or accompany some object, perhaps as a label. In any case, it is the first kind of document of this type to survive. Although somewhat polished along the edges and the cutting, the recto is quite worn, which makes it difficult to decide how many signs really survive. The verso is not inscribed.

The recto shows at least three signs, one of which—the middle one, which is less deeply incised than the top and bottom ones—has certainly been erased. The signs are oddly situated in irregular positions and were finely incised (c.1 mm deep). The identification of the signs poses some problems, partly caused by the damaged surface of the disc.

The top sign is a hapax although graphically it resembles A 344 on Haghia Triada tablet HT 96a.4. The Wy 22 sign, however, consists of two horizontal bars carried by four legs which are shaped as inverted triangles. A smaller inverted triangle is placed on top of and slightly to the left of the top horizontal bar, whereas another, larger but finer (and probably erased) triangle can be seen above the centre of the horizontal bars. Finally, at the right hand end of the bars, where the surface of the disc flakes off, traces of another stroke survive (erased?). A 344 on HT 96 shows three legs and a serrated top bar and is surmounted by a cross at the right hand side. There is a possibility that both the sign of Wy 22 and A 344 are related to AB 131, the WINE logogram,⁹⁴ although the latter sign never

⁹¹ The tablet and painted inscription were published in *GORILA* vols. 1 and 4; for Zb 19 and Zb 21, see *BSA* 82 (1987), 153; 86 (1991), 146–7.

⁹² We follow E. Hallager's new classification of Linear A W-documents (cf. E. Hallager, 'Nomenclature of administrative Linear A documents', in S. Dager-Jalkotzy, S. Hiller, and O. Panagl (eds), *Proceedings of the Tenth International Conference on Mycenaean Studies, Salzburg 1995* (in press). Since the object here does not show any seal impressions on the edge as roundels do and is pierced, whereas roundels never are, it deserves to be classified separately. Some other awkward documents, previously classified as roundels, have now also been brought into separate categories (e.g. Ph Wc 47 as Zb 47, Ph Wc 42 as Wy 42).

⁹³ Many Linear A documents were intentionally cut, hence there is no reason to speculate about the possibility of the disc ever having been formed in a way similar to that hidden behind the so-called 'simili-joins', records first entirely inscribed and then intentionally divided up in separate documents for different purposes (see J. Driessen, 'Observations on simili-joins in the Room of the Chariot Tablets at Knossos', in J. T. Killen, J. L. Melena, and J.-P. Olivier (eds), *Studies in Mycenaean and Classical Greek Presented to John Chadwick* (= *Minos* 20–2; Salamanca, 1987), 151–62).

⁹⁴ For a detailed discussion of wine logograms in Aegean scripts, see R. Palmer, *Wine in the Mycenaean Palace Economy* (Aegaeum, 10; Liège, 1994), 2.

consists of four legs (here eight lines forming three inverted triangles). The maximum number of legs of the AB 131 sign seems to be three (i.e. at the most six lines forming three inverted triangles) and this is on a Cretan Hieroglyphic document from Knossos (P 87a). A variant of AB 131 occurring at Khania has, however, four simple legs consisting of two vertical and two oblique traits (AB 131c). The latter has, moreover, a V-shaped sign above the horizontal bar.

The sign in the centre of the disc is probably erased. It consisted of at least four vertical strokes, topped by a horizontal bar and with two oblique strokes within the area of the central vertical strokes. On top of the horizontal bar, traces of what may have been a triangle can still be discerned. The whole is probably erased but it may be assumed that a sign similar to the one preserved above was originally intended.

To the right of the previous sign are some traits which may either be unintentional scratches or remains of an erased sign or signs. If the latter, we might recognize perhaps three horizontal strokes (for 30) and two oblique crossing strokes (cf. AB 46–7 or even A 100/102).

The bottom sign again is awkward. It resembles a triangle lying on its side with extended lines along the bottom. There may be four such lines (the lowest one being partly on the edge of the document). The ductus suggests that the bar from which these horizontal lines depart was traced first, and the triangle seems to be the extension of two of the lower lines, crossing the vertical bar. As such the sign seems to be unique. The only suggestion we can offer is that it is again an unsuccessful attempt to produce a sign similar to the ones above.

Hence, at the same time unique and frustrating, Wy 22 is a new type of (presumably) administrative document: the cutting and perforation made it possible to divide it up into two independent documents which could perhaps be involved in some kind of transaction, but the lack of comparative material does not yet invite further speculation.

ZB 23 (PK 94/5119)

A fragment of a coarse pithos rim (c.10 × 5 cm) was picked out of the sherds collected (no. 4448) while excavating a 1905 backfilling operation at the South Façade of Area 6 (ER 81). It shows a finely incised graffito, made after firing, and consists of a rough circle with an inscribed irregular cross and, to the right, one oblique gradually descending line above, a short curving line below and, beneath the latter, a vertical line. All traits are extremely fine and quite difficult to discern (hence the quality of the photograph) but we think the intention is clear. Rather than representing a badly drawn AB 87 (KA), it is a doodle of a chariot and an attempt to sketch its most striking features, the wheel and the traction pole. As such it is quite similar to the conventional drawings of the Linear B chariot logogram as known from the records of the Room of the Chariot Tablets at Knossos or the WHEEL logograms, again attested foremost in Linear B collections on Crete and the Mainland.

If this interpretation as a chariot doodle is correct, it suggests that people of Bronze Age Palaikastro were familiar with the existence of such vehicles and represented them in a way not very different from that of the palatial bureaucrats at Knossos.

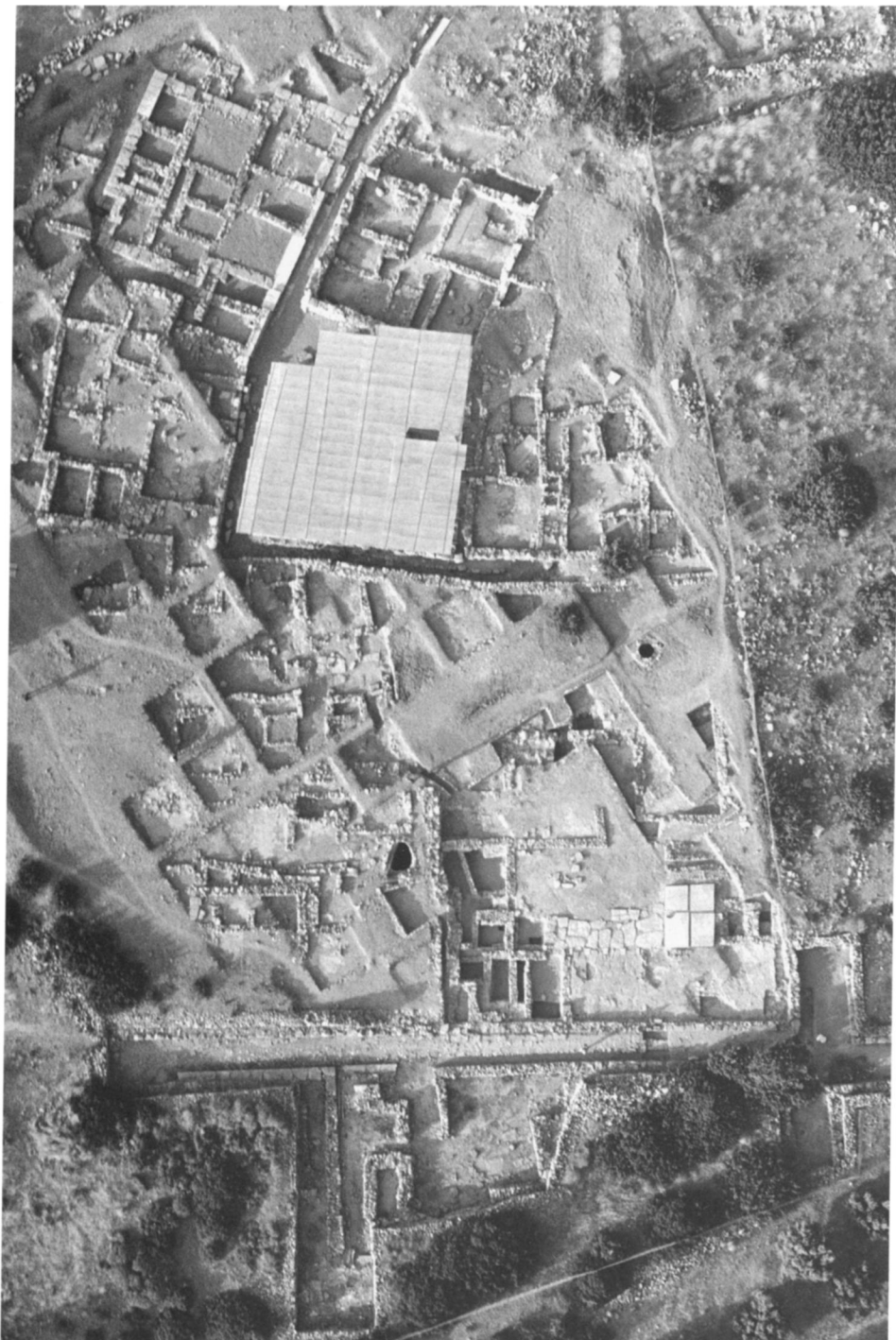
ZB 24 (PK 94/5845 NO. 0853)

The handle of a medium-sized LM II–III A1 oval-mouthed amphora from the fill levels in Well 576 (for which see above) shows a WINE logogram (AB 131), deeply incised after firing (c.1.4 to 2.0 mm deep and wide). The logogram is of the very simple type and is common in

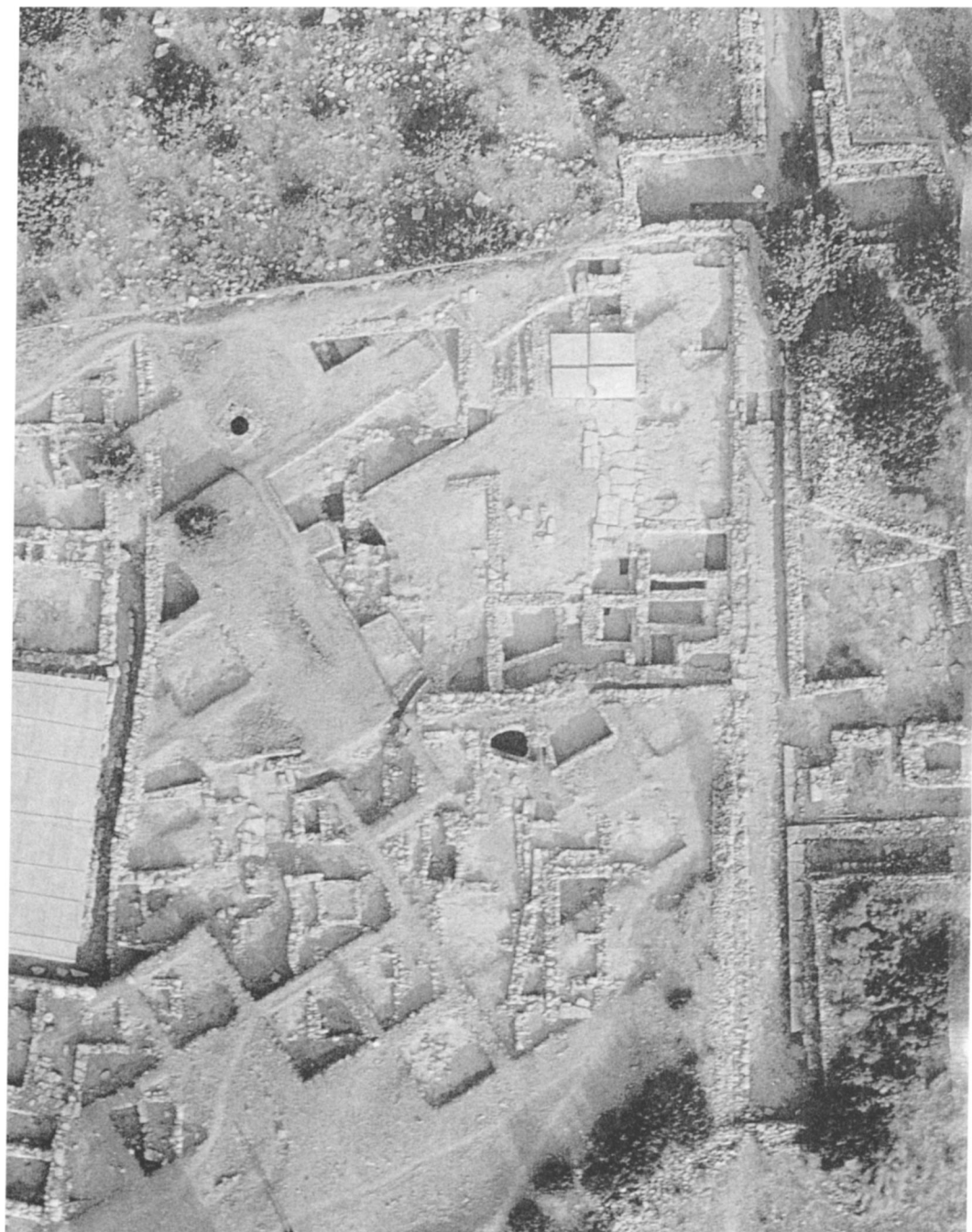
Linear A and Linear B. It is unusual, however, in not having any of the characteristic diagonal strokes between the legs, which mostly slope down to the left (cf. AB 131b). Although strictly speaking not impossible, clay containers are only rarely given incised signs in Linear B (e.g. Pylos) which suggests that we are dealing with a Linear A practice. If the date of the vessel and the type of script are correctly identified, Zb 24 adds to the list of signs for limited Linear A literacy during the LM II–III A period on Crete (Kephala tholos and vase from the Unexplored Mansion at Knossos, figurine from Poros).

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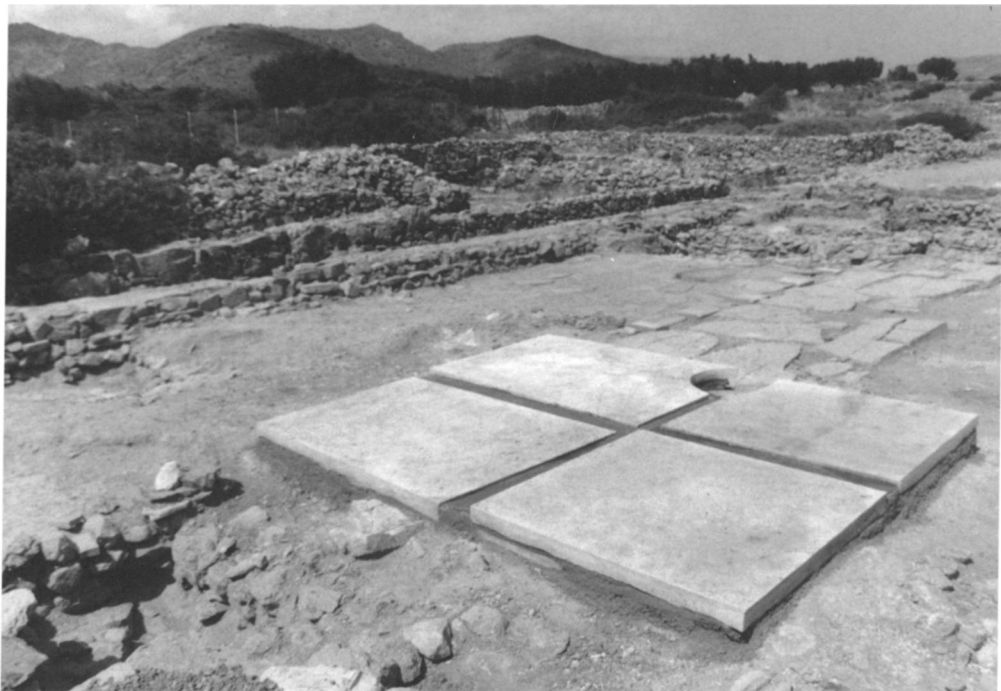
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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996
Aerial photo of Buildings 1-6, 1996. (Copyright J. Driessen-F.W.O., K. U. Leuven)



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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996
Detail of air photo, showing Building 6.



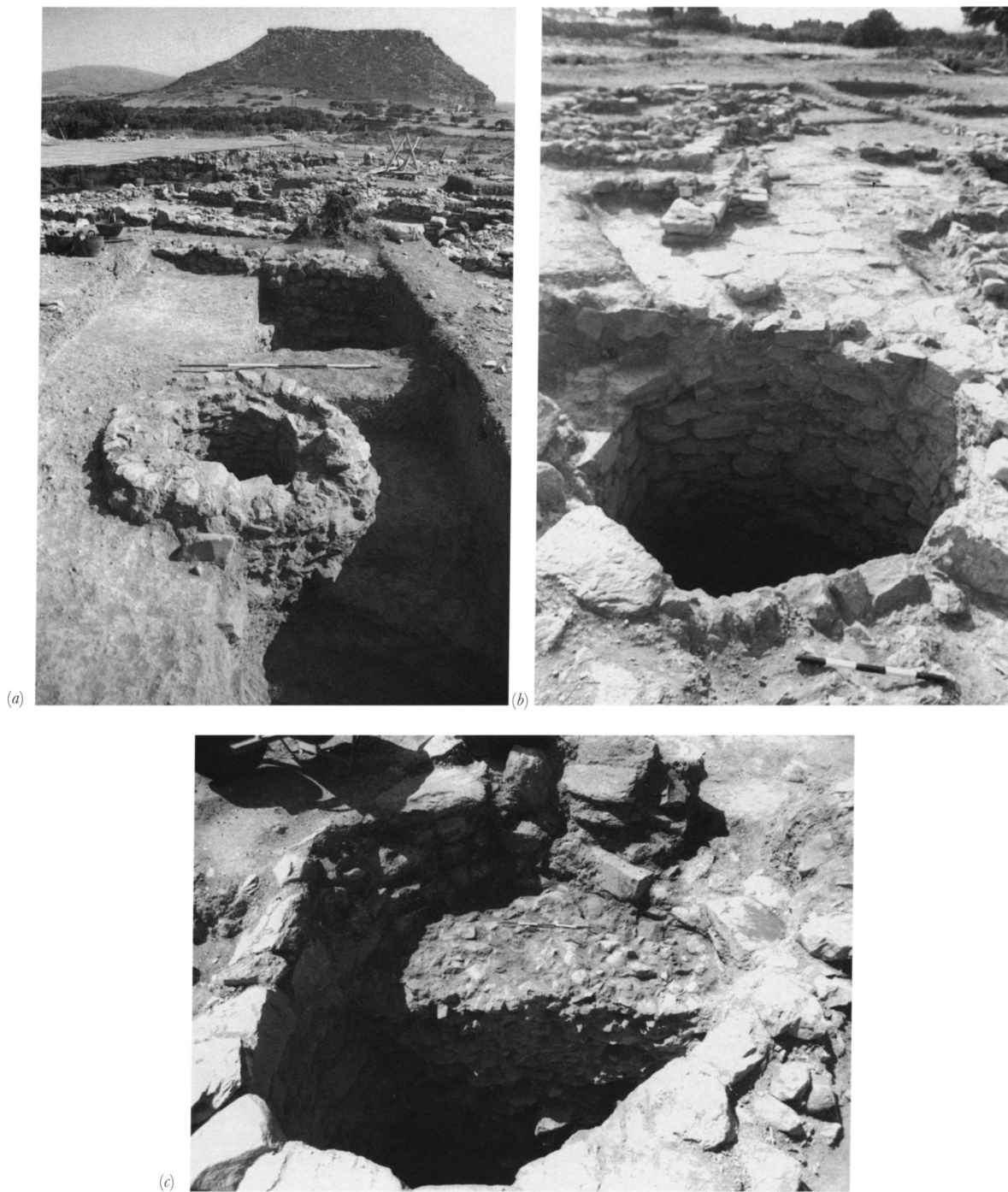
(a)



(b)

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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

View over Building 6 to west, showing protective conservation of paving slabs at Room G; (a) in progress, (b) completed.



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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

(a) Well 605, view north over Buildings 5 and 7 to Kastro; (b) Well 576, view west over paved court and southwest quarter; (c) Well 576, upper fill with LM III A2/B pottery including conical cups.

PLATE 42



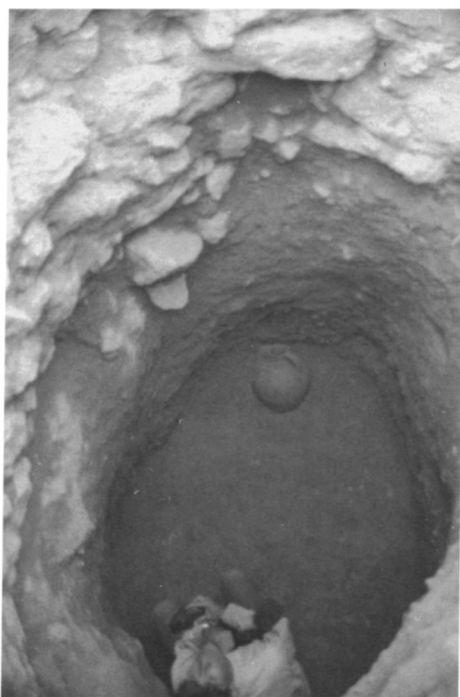
(a)



(b)



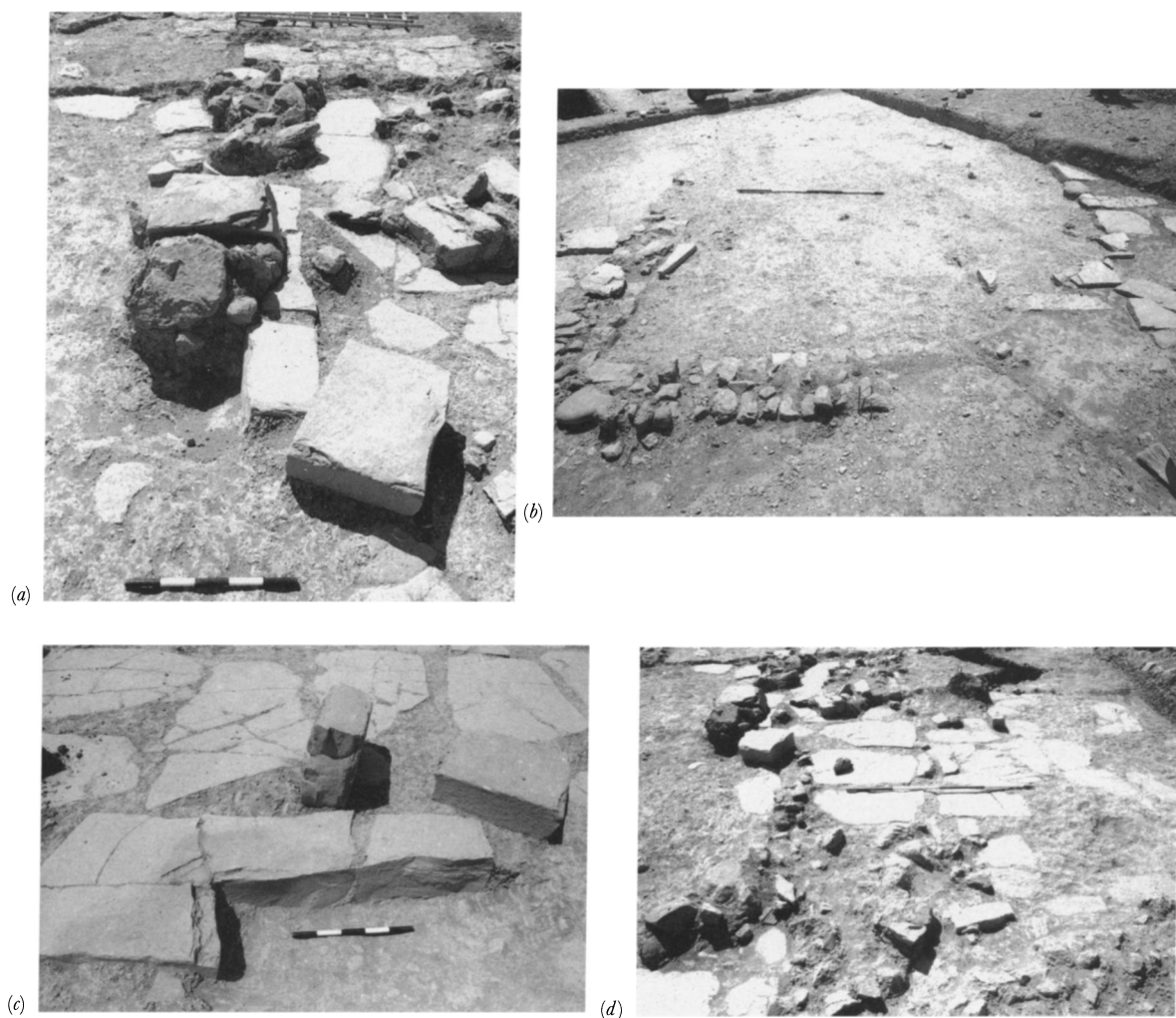
(c)



(d)

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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

(a) Drain J, deposit of Thera ash; (b) Drain J, view from west; (c) The North Terrace Wall (eroded), view from west; packing for floor of M ends at line of ranging rod, (d) Well 576, LM III A amphora at depth c.7.0 m.



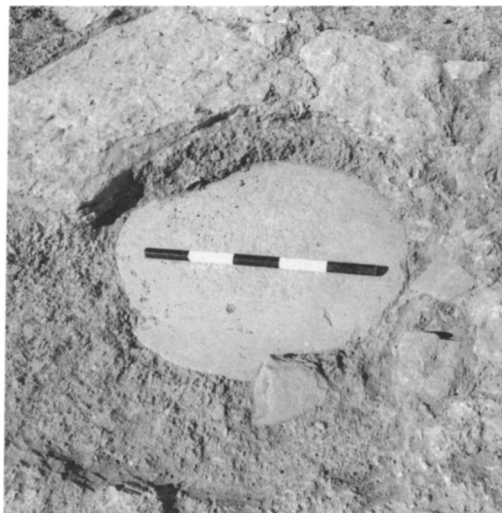
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 EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

The central court: (a) upper floor tumble and robbing debris at south colonnade; (b) central plastered floor, with stony packing for peristyle at edges, view from west; (c) large sideropetra slab of south colonnade, deliberately prised up in the LM I A period, (d) upper floor collapse at the line of the polythyron.

PLATE 44



(a)



(b)



(c)

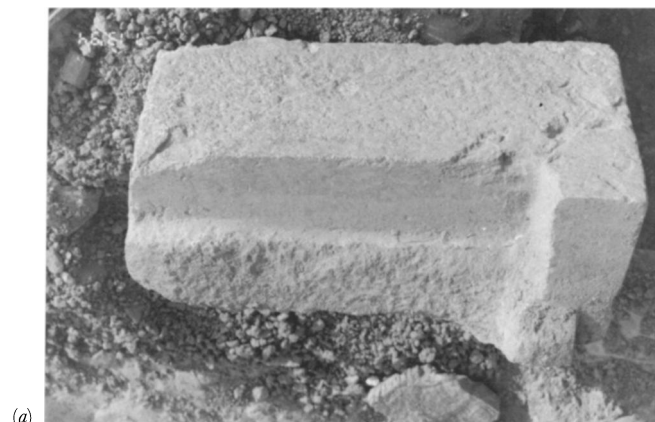


(d)

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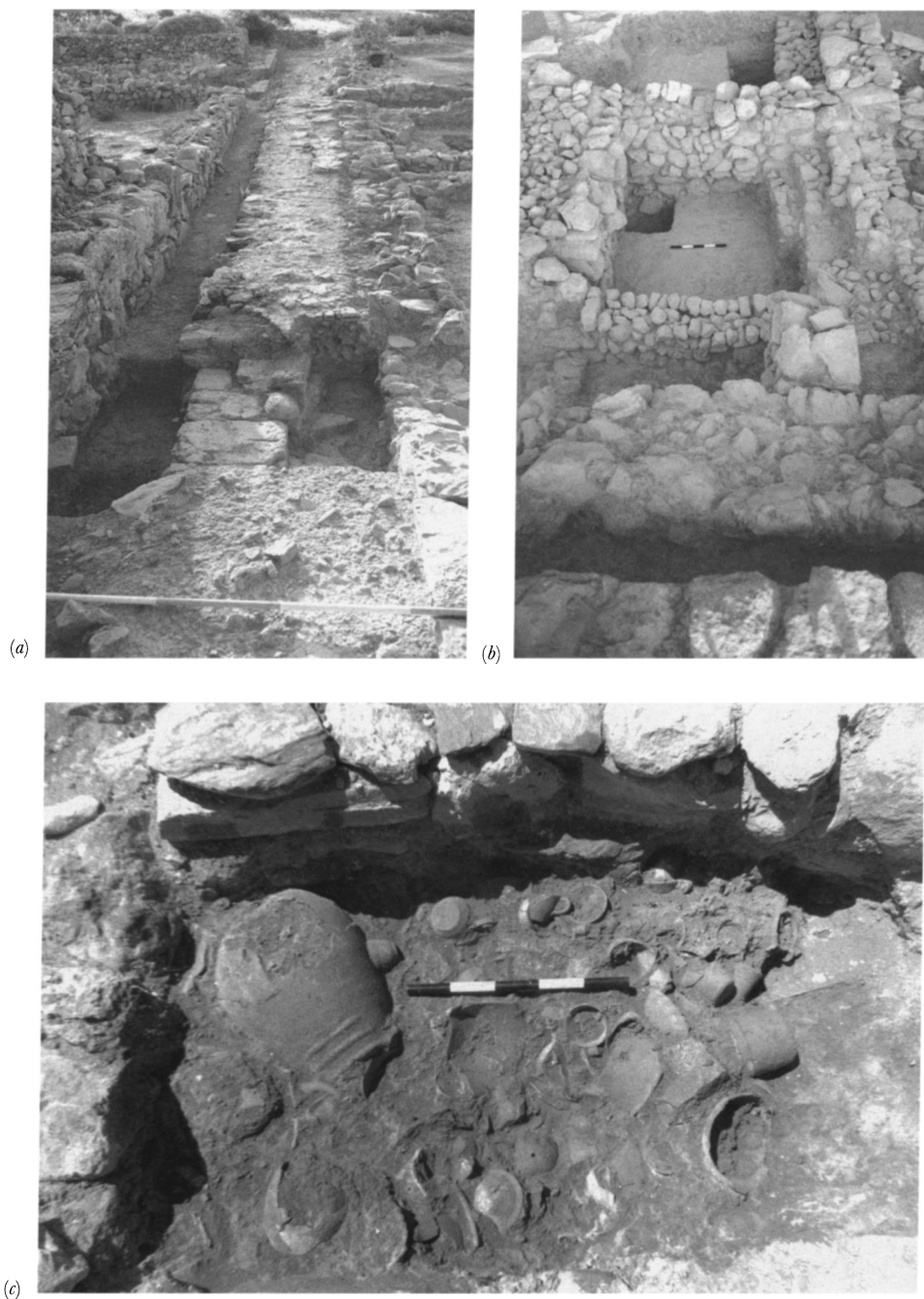
EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

The south colonnade and its paved polythyron: (a) the two column bases at the east; (b) blue limestone column base with earth matrix for wooden column; (c) the polythyron: western door-jamb of green serpentine; (d) the polythyron: central pier base.



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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996
(a)–(c) Details of the serpentine door-jamb bases; (d) the polythyron bases restored.

PLATE 46



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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

- (a) 'Main Street', view west, showing test with earlier (MM) roadway; tephra in drain at right, (b) Rooms E1, E2 and (top centre) test in corner of Court H; view from West Façade (two phases in foreground), (c) Compartment R1, MM III B destruction deposit.

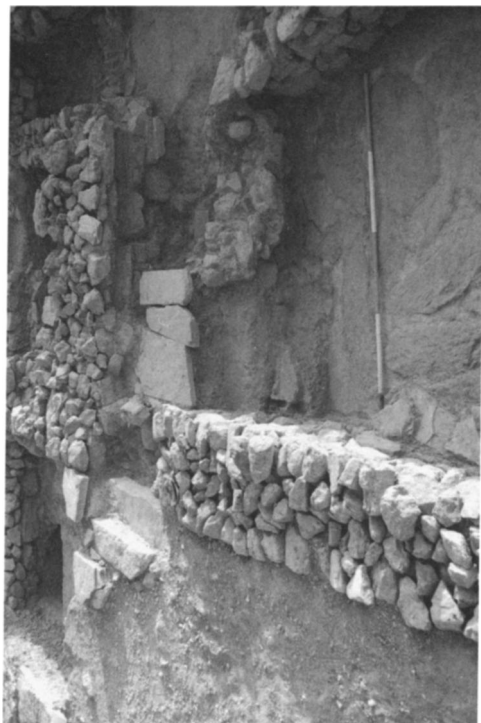
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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996

(a) View of west wing (Rooms L, E, D, C, B and test in Court H); from N 1996; (b)-(d) Room L: (b) two phases of stepped entrance way; (c) paved floor of phase 1 with sunken area, phase 2 dividing wall at right; (d) collapse of the West Façade into Rooms L1 and 2.



(a)



(b)

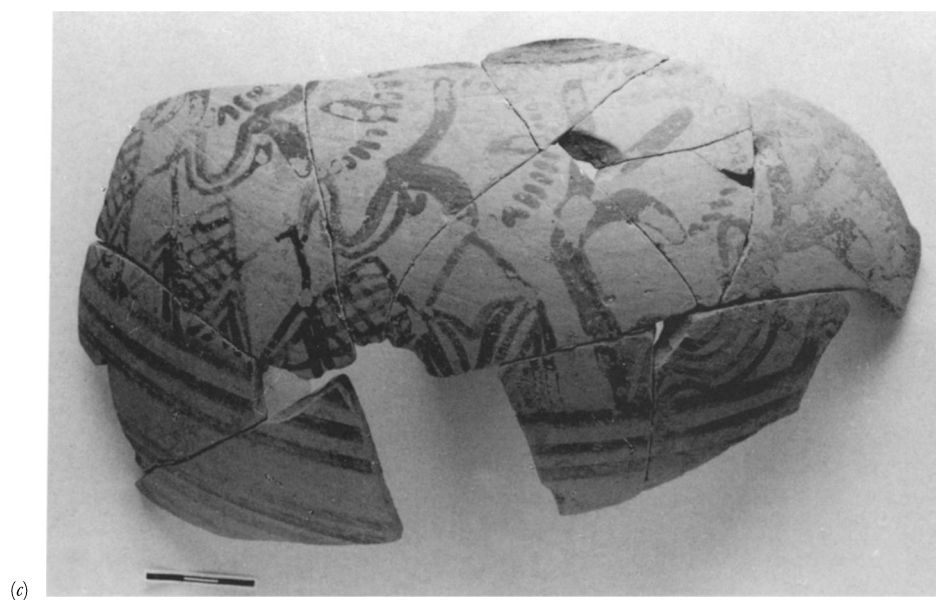
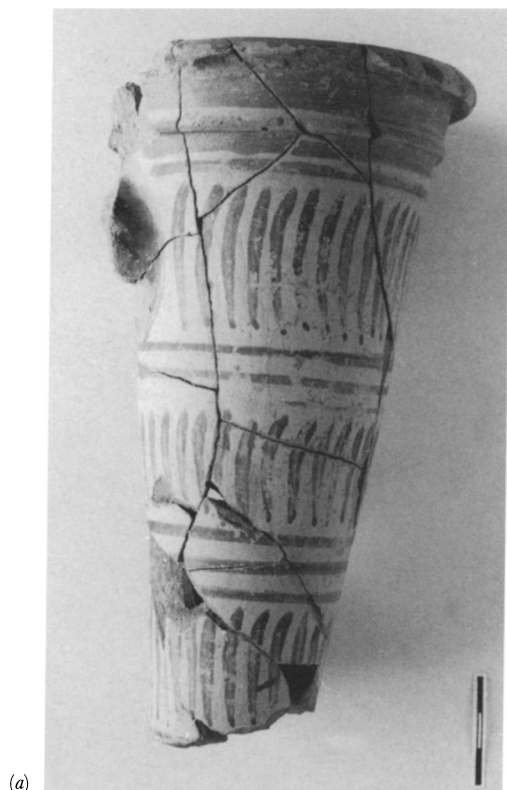


(c)



(d)

PLATE 48



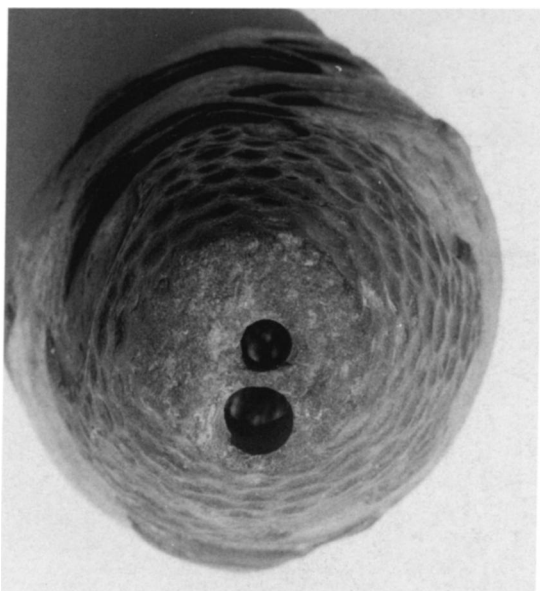
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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996
Decorated pottery from the fill of Wells 605 and 576.



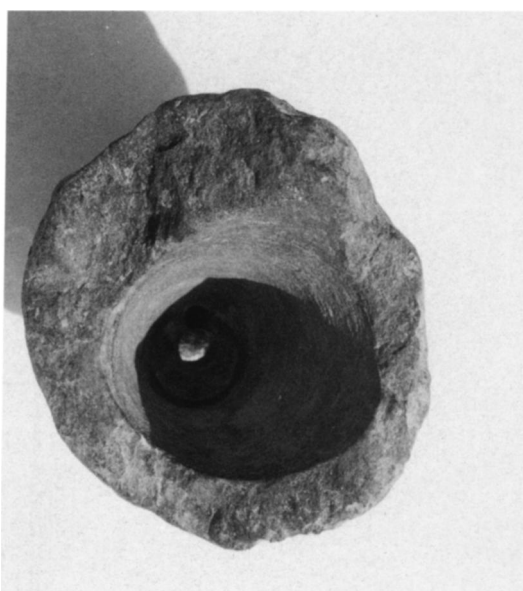
(a)



(b)



(c)



(d)

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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996
Serpentine rhyton fragment with dolphins, from fill of Well 605.



(a)



(b)



(c)

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EXCAVATIONS AT PALAIKASTRO, 1994 AND 1996
Inscribed disc and sherds from Palaikastro 1994; (a) Wy22; (b) Zb23; (c) Zb24.